

1:43

Indian Bank

VBX Spark

Account Summary

₹ XXXX.XX Savings(1)

₹ XXXX.XX OD/ CC(0)

₹ XXXX.XX Deposits(0)

₹ XXXX.XX Loans(0)

Account Details

Account Statement

m-Passbook

Fund Transfers

Virtual RM

Benefits (Tier)

Invest

Call Back

UPI

Rewards

Open e-Term...

Open OD Against...

Bill Payments...

Help / Raise Support...

Wealth Mgmt. ~...

Apply New Loan

Debit Card

Credit Card

Mutual Funds IBMBS

Manage Payee

Easy Pay

Recharge

Manage Limits

Manage Payee

इंडियन बैंक Indian Bank

OPEN THE WORLD OF VBX

Seamless, secure, and personalized Virtual Banking Experience through the enhanced INDSMART

Dedicated Virtual RM

Priority Service

Robo Advisory for Wealth & Investment

Reward Programs

SMS

Waiver on SMS charges

Call back request

TOTAL BUSINESS
₹15,29,201 Cr
Up by 13.66 % Y.o.Y

TOTAL DEPOSITS
₹8,44,578 Cr
Up by 13.47% Y.o.Y

GROSS ADVANCES
₹6,84,623 Cr
Up by 13.89 % Y.o.Y

RAM (Retail, Agriculture, MSME)
₹4,16,992 Cr
Up by 14.80% Y.o.Y

NET PROFIT
₹3,273 Cr
Up by 10.09% Y.o.Y

GROSS NPA
1.86%
Down by 115 bps Y.o.Y

NET NPA
0.15%
Down by 3 bps Y.o.Y

NIM (Domestic)
3.41 %
RoA 1.31%

Unaudited (Reviewed) Financial Results (Standalone/Consolidated) for the Quarter Ended June 30, 2026 (Rs. in crore)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone			Consolidated		
		Quarter Ended		Year Ended	Quarter Ended		Year Ended
		30.06.2026 (Reviewed)	30.06.2025 (Reviewed)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	30.06.2026 (Reviewed)	30.06.2025 (Reviewed)	31.03.2026 (Audited)
1	Total income from operations	20723.62	18721.31	77441.29	20997.38	18905.60	78332.70
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	4361.57	4079.28	16403.72	4394.46	4101.36	16501.54
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	4361.57	4079.28	16403.72	4394.46	3334.77	15734.95
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	3273.09	2972.82	12155.65	3356.63	2276.37	11704.28
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [comprising profit/(loss) for the period (after tax) and other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of previous year)	69876.76	60762.20	69876.76	71628.40	62965.17	71628.40
8	Securities Premium Account	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02
9	Net Worth	68792.77	60383.20	65627.59			
10	Paid up Debt Capital/Outstanding Debt**	23941.82	22234.61	22421.14			
11	Debt Equity Ratio**	0.35	0.37	0.34			
12	Earnings Per Share (of ₹10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)						
	Basic :	*24.30	*22.07	90.24	*24.92	*16.90	86.89
	Diluted :	*24.30	*22.07	90.24	*24.92	*16.90	86.89
13	Capital Redemption Reserve	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
14	Debenture Redemption Reserve	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
15	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
16	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

* Not Annualised ** Debt represents borrowing with residual maturity of more than one year.

Note: 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange(s) websites (www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com) and Bank's website (www.indianbank.bank.in).

2. Information relating to Total Comprehensive Income and other Comprehensive Income is not furnished as Ind AS is not yet made applicable to the Bank.

Place: Chennai
Date: 10.07.2026

Mini T M
Executive Director

Shiv Bajrang Singh
Executive Director

Ashutosh Choudhury
Executive Director

Binod Kumar
Managing Director & CEO

Corporate Office: 254-260, Avvai Shanmugam Salai, Royapettah, Chennai - 600 014.

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QUICKLY.

Nissan Tekton launched in India starting at ₹10.49 lakh



The Tekton is Nissan's take on the Renault Duster SUV. It's being offered with either a 1-litre, 3-cylinder or a 1.3-litre, 4-cylinder engine, both being turbo-petrols. While the 1-litre engine can only be had with a 6-speed manual, the 1.3 gets the option of a 6-speed manual as well as a 6-speed dual clutch automatic transmission. Spread across six variants, prices start at ₹10.49 lakh, going up to ₹18.59 lakh (ex-showroom, Delhi) for the top-end variant.

Yamaha announces pricing for the Aerox-E



The electric derivative of Yamaha's performance flagship in the scooter class, the Aerox-E, has been launched at ₹2.81 lakh (ex-showroom, Bengaluru). While visually identical to the Aerox 155 (colour scheme aside), the Aerox-E is powered by two removable 1.5 kWh batteries that weigh 13 kg each. Peak power is 12.6 bhp and the claimed (IDC) range is 117 km. For now, the Aerox-E is available only in Bengaluru, Chennai, Delhi, Mumbai and Pune.

Ferrari unleashes the 12Cilindri Manuale



Ferrari's 12-cylinder supercar has spawned an old-school, 6-speed gated manual gearbox — except, it isn't actually one. Replete with shift gates and even a clutch pedal, the Manuale essentially features an 8-speed dual-clutch transmission that simulates the mechanical feel of the now-extinct Ferrari manual gearbox, using the gearshift stick and clutch pedals as DCT actuators. Powering the Manuale is an 820 bhp, naturally-aspirated V12 which translates to a 0-100 kph time of just 2.9 seconds — surprisingly, in either of its gearbox modes!

@TheMotorGram

Brag Strip Bruiser

POWER OF X. The BMW X6 makes a comeback and it's more M-powering than ever before. The new leader of the pack, then?

YASH GAWDE

Ruman Devmane

I'd have picked a very different day to drive a car like that. The car you see in the accompanying photograph, just so you know, features a 4.4-litre twin-turbocharged V8 engine that produces 523 bhp. Those are 523 of highly pedigreed horses, which means laying them down is hardly a matter of talent. All you need to do is find room to do so. Although, I feel far less brave on rainy days. On second thought, maybe this was a good thing in the context of self-preservation.

While it's backed up by brazenly bold specifications, what really is the X6 all about? For starters, it's no new nameplate to the world or even to India, for that matter.

In its early days, it often polarised opinions for its unprecedented attempt at merging an SUV with a pronounced coupe-like rear end, but like with most hotly debated BMWs that was soon forgotten. Eventually, the X6 carved a niche for itself by primarily being a really enjoyable car to drive, while being distinctly different to the X5.

It hasn't been around for the last handful of years, though, so BMW thought it fit to mark its return in a way you couldn't miss. That explains why it's called the X6 M60i and BMW's many worshippers will know exactly why this car/SUV/coupe is a very big deal. I must apologise for the somewhat unflattering photographs, but the X6 looks properly handsome in the flesh.

360 DEGREE TOUR
Its muscular hunched-down stance and width give it the presence of something special, and even those not inclined will struggle to ignore it for the raucous burble its quartet

of exhaust pipes emit. On the spec front, this X6 wears as many M bits as BMW could assemble. The 21-inch wheels, for instance, are stunning and look like they mean business. The blacked-out bits of trim, headlined by the kidney grille, look sinister.

The cabin is a sea of deep red. And there is an unmistakable sense of occasion to everything about this X6. It's dramatic from every angle. I'd have liked to see it wear a more dramatic colour, perhaps, but that's the only thing I'll grudge it for now.

Inside, think of the X6 more as a 2+2 GT — an exceptionally good and practical one — and you'll like what follows. This is undoubtedly a front-row car. The seats look sporty, but in reality they're built for long-range comfort. There's seat ventilation (of course) and also a terrific massage function with a host of modes, all of which really do work as advertised. The steering is perfectly round and not flat-bottomed. There's a darkened panoramic sunroof, even, and it features an electronically retractable sun shade as well.

Given a choice, I wouldn't choose to be seated at the back. While the seat itself is plush enough, the floor is a bit high-set, the windows are quite small and the sloping roofline (even though it doesn't affect headroom) really takes away from any sense of largesse. While space itself isn't at a premium — not by a long shot — it simply isn't the most appealing place to spend a long time in. A collapsible armrest (with cupholder extensions) does allow direct access to the boot, though, which is helpful. Speaking of which, the boot is quite brilliant! The flat and high boot floor (no space-saver) should see no trouble swallowing a lengthy road trip's worth of luggage. A 2+2 GT, then. Agree?



DETAIL TALE. For a performance-biased BMW, the X6's cabin is rather plush. The comfortable seats make long journeys a real possibility, though some plastics feel dated

YASH GAWDE

It drives like one, too. Rather, you'll find yourself settling into this frame of mind once you've had your fill of driving it impatiently. In Sport+ mode, which sets the suspension, steering and drivetrain to their most aggressive, the X6 is unbelievably (for its mass, that is) agile. In an instant, it behaves as if it were a low-slung sports coupe — the kind BMW is rather excellent at building — and it shows, equally, in how remorselessly it accelerates as well as how it corners.

All the while, you can hear its powerful V8 engine produce an ad-

dictive soundtrack with a faint old-world burble that's worth every penny. Of course, there's a bit of gimmicky sound reproduction through the speakers as well, but even with the feature turned off, it still sounds fantastic.

While you may struggle to find utility in its speed, to be truthful, it just feels so good to have 76.47 kg-m of torque and a rapid 8-speed gearbox. Even under the speed limit, there's enough 'feel' to the X6 which makes it so memorable to drive. The best bit, though, is how easy it is to drive fast. I'm sure this

is a car better suited to the first world on the usability front, but that it made me want to keep driving it in Mumbai — through red-alert levels of rain — should tell you something about its character. An everyday supercar? This might just do the trick for you! You shouldn't feel irresponsible, either, because it also features a 48 V mild-hybrid motor! That's not to say it's perfect, of course. There's a shocking absence of premiumness to a lot of plastic buttons (steering wheel, door panels), for example, and while they may be built well, they don't feel so to the touch. The rear seat is definitely a compromise even if to a subjective degree and the lack of a spare wheel (or a space-saver) can never be a good thing, right? You also have to remember to disengage all collision-avoidance features every time you restart the car, although it's something you can quickly adapt to. The one 'flaw' you can look past is the narrow outward visibility from the rear windscreen which is angled to seem nearly horizontal. This isn't such an issue because the parking cameras are fantastic, but on a rainy day, especially without a rear wash/wipe feature, you have no view whatsoever.

You could say these are things you sign up for when choosing a car of this kind and you wouldn't be wrong, I suppose.

What about its peers? Well, the X6 slots in between the Audi SQ8, the Mercedes-AMG GLE coupe and the Porsche Cayenne, and objectively speaking, choosing one is a matter of what stirs you emotionally. At ₹1.78 crore (ex-showroom, Delhi), the X6 M60i is cleverly priced, but is it the one you should choose over the rest? I'll have to drive one on a sunny day to let you know!

@TheMotorGram



Red Hot

WORTH ITS WAIT? The Skoda Kodiaq RS isn't cheap, but is it appealing enough to make you queue up for one?



TOP NOTCH. The all-black interior looks the part and is beautifully executed. The panoramic roof adds a nice touch to the spacious cabin

PRASHANT SHETTY

Ruman Devmane

Don't drive the Kodiaq RS. I mean it. Unless you are comfortably equipped to bring one home, which includes finding yourself a spot on Skoda's waiting list, you must do your best to steer clear of this car. It's that good.

Sounds like I'm gushing? True, but not for the same reason as you might suspect. This Kodiaq sure wears the RS moniker and it looks the part, too, but there's some-

thing deeper to it than outright performance-driven supremacy. That, some may debate, is still the mantle of the Octavia RS, given that it's a sedan. Fair enough. The Kodiaq RS, however, is something that feels great to drive even if you happen to be moving house in it. It has figured duality out to perfection. Being a CBU import, Skoda has set aside just 50 units of the Kodiaq RS for India (for the time being) and, unsurprisingly, they've all been spoken for. It's unclear when the next batch will arrive, but unless you move quickly, that lot will be usurped

just as quickly, too. What's the big deal about it, you ask? Well, it has got a 261-bhp turbo-petrol by the way of an ice-breaker, and it's wearing an RS badge. That's enough for most car enthusiasts, but the Kodiaq RS doesn't stop there, of course.

There's a 7-speed dual-clutch gearbox with paddle shifters, adaptive damping (dynamic chassis control) which offers 15 levels of adjustability, and there's even an individual drive mode that allows you to configure suspension stiffness, drivetrain responsiveness and steering weight as well. It's

got AWD, too, and paired with inner-wheel braking tech, the Kodiaq counters understeer rather brilliantly. There's ADAS as well, and I'm happy to report it takes no time to turn it off.

ROAD CALLING

From behind the wheel, the Kodiaq RS feels very special. It's a proper RS number and it sounds the part, too. Even the artificial soundtrack is inoffensively done and, from the onset, it gets you in the mood for spirited driving. This worked out rather well for my 250-km day with it, as you can

imagine. Skoda claims a 0-100-kph time of 6.3 seconds, which I found to be true, and, given the confidence it inspires, I nearly attempted to verify its 231-kph top speed as well. It's spectacularly engaging and yet, it very much is a Kodiaq. I verified this, too, by driving the non-RS right after.

You'd think of the RS as an unforgiving car and that couldn't be further from the truth.

In reality, with its upgraded suspension, it actually rides as well as the made-in-India Kodiaq, if not better! Yes, even with 20-inch wheels instead of the 18s on

the standard Kodiaq. For all its sporty inclinations, the cabin still is perfectly suited to a full-sized family, although the third row is best left to kids or, even better, folded flat so you get a 786-litre boot.

Is it a car you can road trip with, then? Easily. And it'll get you there quicker than anything else can, for that price.

HIGH STAKES

Speaking of which, is its price tag of ₹67 lakh justified? Without a doubt. The Kodiaq RS is as poised as it is premium and it feels so, in

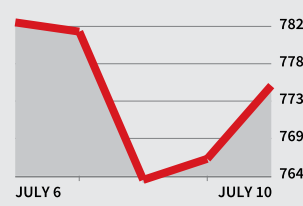
every aspect. That it's a driver's car your family won't grudge you buying only helps its case.

How about something electric, then? Sure, but it just won't feel as pure and exciting as the Kodiaq RS. If that's something that matters to you — driving pleasure — the Kodiaq RS is very hard to beat. It's a car with a great deal of finesse and sophistication and, above all else, a personality that's impossible not to love. Unless you take my word for it and don't drive it, that is.

@TheMotorGram

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77569.39 (+827.57)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24206.90	+244.10
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	21.04	+0.21
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.32	-0.06
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	142794.00	-287
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	220390.00	-3404

TIME TO RESET.

Ex-NITI Aayog member Ramesh Chand calls for alternative procurement policy and MSP via price differential payment **p8**



DOLLAR DEPOSITS.

Indian Bank raises \$140 million in FCNR (B) deposits post new RBI rule **p5**

QUICKLY.

TRADE PUSH

FTA, \$20 b investment top Modi's New Zealand agenda



New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi's priorities during his New Zealand visit, which began on Friday, include early ratification and implementation of the recently signed free trade agreement (FTA) and operationalising the \$20 billion investment pipeline. He is expected to begin discussions on these issues with New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon on Saturday. **p3**

USERNAME NOTICE

Govt examining WhatsApp's reply

New Delhi: The government on Friday said it has received the reply from WhatsApp to a notice on the username feature and currently it is "examining" the responses sent by the instant messaging platform. WhatsApp's reply was received on Thursday night as per the deadline given to the platform by MeitY, sources said. **p10**

Ethanol blending to shield users from oil shocks: Govt

FAQ. E20 cheaper than petrol only if crude hits \$120-130/bbl; blending is to keep import bill down

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The Centre on Friday argued that the ethanol blending programme is to shield consumers from global crude oil price shocks rather than reducing petrol prices at the pump, even as it acknowledged that E20 petrol is costlier to produce than conventional petrol when international crude prices are around \$70 a barrel.

In a detailed FAQ, the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas said the real objective of ethanol blending is to reduce India's dependence on imported crude by ensuring that nearly one-fifth of every litre of petrol sold is domestically produced ethanol, the price of which remains insulated from daily swings in global oil markets.

SUBDUED CRUDE

The government's argument comes against the backdrop of relatively subdued crude prices in recent years. According to data from the Pet-



FUEL EFFICIENCY. The Oil Ministry acknowledged that some vehicles may experience a 3-5 per cent reduction in mileage with E20 but touted the many other plus points of the fuel

roleum Planning and Analysis Cell (PPAC), the Indian basket of crude averaged \$93.15 a barrel in FY23, \$82.58 in FY24, \$78.56 in FY25 and \$70.99 in FY26.

Between January 2023 and July 2026, the Indian basket crossed the \$100-a-barrel mark only three times — March 2026 (\$113.49), April 2026 (\$114.48) and May 2026 (\$106.23).

ETHANOL ECONOMICS

"Today, government purchases ethanol at remunerative prices so that Indian farmers are fairly compensated. Take maize-based ethanol. We have progress-

ively increased its procurement price and today it is around ₹71.86 per litre, even before GST, transportation, storage and depot handling costs," the Ministry said.

Consequently, when crude is around \$70 a barrel, E20 (80 per cent petrol and 20 per cent ethanol) is more expensive to produce than pure petrol. However, if crude prices climb to \$120-130 a barrel, the economics reverse and ethanol becomes the cheaper component, it said. "The real question is not why is E20 not cheaper, but how did India manage to protect consumers from the full impact of volatile global

crude prices," the Ministry said.

It also addressed concerns over the availability of different petrol blends, saying India cannot simultaneously maintain separate nationwide supply chains for E10, E12, E15 and E20 fuels. Creating parallel infrastructure for storage, transportation and dispensing of multiple blends would increase logistics costs and operational complexity across the fuel distribution network, it said.

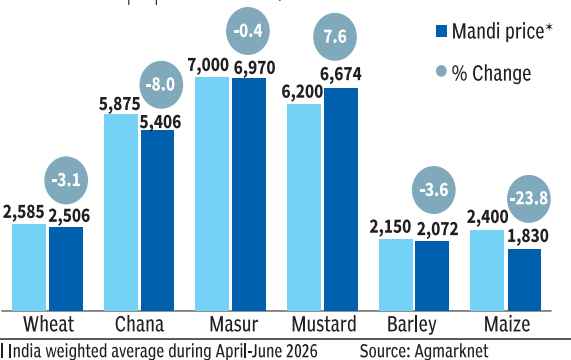
Instead, India has adopted a phased transition to E20 after consultations with automobile manufacturers, oil marketing companies and other stakeholders.

Responding to concerns over fuel efficiency, the Ministry acknowledged that some vehicles may experience a 3-5 per cent reduction in mileage with E20. However, it said the fuel offers a higher octane rating, superior anti-knock properties, better combustion, smoother acceleration and cleaner engine operation while reducing lifecycle carbon emissions by 40 per cent.

Rabi blues: Key crops sold 3-8% below MSP; at 24%, maize worst hit

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Rabi crop prices (₹/quintal)



Key rabi season crops — wheat, chana (gram) and barley — sold at an average of 3-8 per cent below their respective minimum support prices (MSPs) in *mandis* (agricultural market yards) during the main harvesting period of April-June.

Maize prices were the worst affected from the farmers' perspective, ruling 24 per cent below the MSP, whereas masur (lentil) was almost at par with the benchmark rate.

However, the season's main oilseed crop, mustard, emerged a winner. It sold 8 per cent higher at an average of ₹6,674/quintal against the MSP of ₹6,200 during April-June, and has now jumped to ₹7,227/quintal, up 17 per cent from the benchmark rate.

AVERAGE PRICES

The average *mandi* prices on July 8 show that, except for wheat, all other crops are now ruling above their past three-month averages, according to *mandi* price data maintained by the Agmarknet portal. While better

rates are seen as helping farmers who depend solely on agricultural crops, any substantial rise can also contribute to higher food inflation. The pan-India average farmgate price for wheat was ₹2,506/quintal during April-June, down 3 per cent from its MSP of ₹2,585/quintal. On July 8, however, its price dropped further to ₹2,485/quintal.

"Normally, at the peak of the procurement season and peak of arrivals, prices tend to be low but rise later on when the crop is harvested. I am quite surprised that wheat price in July is lower than the average of April-June," said Siraj Hussain, a former Union Agriculture Secretary.

Among cereals, barley, which averaged ₹2,072/quintal in *mandis*, was down 4 per cent from its ₹2,150/quintal MSP during the harvesting season. It has since surged by ₹162 to reach ₹2,234/quintal. Similarly, the price of maize, which is also substantially grown in the rabi and *zaid* seasons, was down 24 per cent at ₹1,830/quintal against its MSP of ₹2,400/quintal. However, the current rate of ₹1,959 shows some improvement.

PULSES CATEGORY

In the pulses, the average *mandi* price of chana at ₹5,406/quintal was 8 per cent below its MSP of ₹5,875/quintal; it now stands at ₹5,649/quintal.

World Bank clears \$890 m for India's rooftop solar project, will also mobilise \$4.2 b in private loans

M Ramesh
Chennai



India has committed to achieving net-zero emissions by 2070

The World Bank's Board of Executive Directors has approved a financing package of \$890 million for India's rooftop solar programme, comprising an \$820 million loan from the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD), a \$60 million concessional loan from the Clean Technology Fund and a \$10 million grant from the IBRD's Livable Planet Fund.

The multilateral lender will also mobilise an estimated \$4.2 billion in private financing through commercial loans to help households install rooftop solar systems.

The financing will support the Centre's PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana, which aims to install rooftop solar sys-

tems in 10 million rural and urban households, reducing electricity bills while boosting domestic manufacturing of rooftop solar equipment.

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

The World Bank said the programme is expected to create around 1.7 million jobs across renewable energy

manufacturing, installation and related services.

India has committed to achieving net-zero emissions by 2070 and increasing the share of non-fossil fuel sources in its electricity mix to 60 per cent by 2035.

While utility-scale solar capacity has expanded rapidly over the past decade, residential rooftop solar adoption has remained relatively modest.

"The World Bank has been supporting India's solar rooftop sector for over a decade, mobilising more than \$2 billion to catalyse market growth from 500 MW to over 27 GW of installed capacity," said Paul Procee, acting Country Director for India at the World Bank. "This new financing will help India scale up residential solar installations, while creating job opportunities across the

supply chain and installation ecosystem."

According to the World Bank, the programme seeks to remove financial barriers to rooftop solar adoption while strengthening the capacity of electricity distribution companies, banks and vendors to deliver integrated services.

BUILDING CAPACITIES

"The programme will transform the residential solar market by removing financial barriers and building the capacity of distribution companies, banks, and vendors to deliver integrated service solutions," said Moez Cherif, Task Team Leader for the programme.

"Through collateral-free financing, households can install solar power and significantly reduce their monthly electricity bills," he said.

PLANTING SEASON



SLOW START. Workers making bundles of paddy saplings as part of nursery operations at Chodavaram village in Krishna district of Andhra Pradesh. Agricultural operations have been delayed due to the late arrival of the monsoon. Planting operations are picking up in some areas with farmers taking up the sowing of paddy **KVS GIRI**

SP Group raises \$650 m via 3-year bond at 14.5%

Mahesh Ravidas Nayak
Mumbai

Shapoorji Pallonji Group is said to have raised \$650 million through a three-year bond issued by group entity Mercury Finance Company, according to market sources.

The bond was priced at a 14.5 per cent coupon. The transaction garnered support from several marquee global investors spanning hedge funds, asset management firms and international banking institutions.

The proceeds will be used to refinance outstanding obligations linked to ₹14,300 crore of zero-coupon debentures issued in 2023 by group holding company Goswami Infratech. The debentures, which were originally due on April 30, had their maturity extended first to June 30 and subsequently to July 31.

India's GCC boom faces maturity test

Nearly 500 have plateaued and are unable to sustain relevance, says a report

Sanjana B
Bengaluru



There is a sharp acceleration in the number of global capability centres being set up in India with some estimates even talking about an ecosystem of 5,000 GCCs by 2030.

But even as an average of a GCC is set up daily, here comes a report that argues that India's model has reached inflection point, and that some 500 centres are unable to realise their full potential.

PLATEAU POINT

The report by UnearthIQ and Embark, titled *The Great Plateau: Why GCCs are Unable to Reach their Full Potential*, says that around 30 per cent of GCCs established after 2020, numbering around 150, have already plateaued. Add to that an estimated 360-370 established before 2020 that are facing similar chal-

lenges. "Most GCCs are built to scale delivery. Few are designed to sustain relevance. The difference lies in design strength and execution discipline. Historically, much focus has been on developing playbooks for setting up GCCs, while little investment has been made in identifying frameworks and interventions to realise their potential," say Gaurav Vasu and Shail Maniar, Co-founders of UnearthIQ.

The plateauing is driven by structural factors rather than operational performance alone. Execution-foc-

used mandates, limited leadership autonomy, weak alignment with evolving enterprise priorities, underinvestment in AI and platform capabilities, and fragmented technology and data foundations are preventing some GCCs from moving to higher-value roles within the enterprise.

BUSINESS STRATEGY

India's ambitions of hosting 5,000 GCCs may come to fruition as setting up centres is the easy part. However, as Vikram Jain, Director of Engineering,

Blackhawk Network, points out, the real risk is depth. "India's ambition should not be measured only by how many GCCs it hosts, but by how many own products, make strategic calls and carry real business accountability," he adds.

However, Kapil Joshi, CEO of IT Staffing at Qness Corp, argues that India is witnessing a natural maturing of the market rather than a slowdown.

"Only 5-7 per cent of GCCs still operate primarily on a cost-arbitrage model, while the vast majority have evolved towards delivery excellence, product ownership, and platform-led innovation. With nearly 50 per cent of new GCCs being AI-first, success will depend on platform engineering capability, AI deployment expertise and the ability to create measurable business impact rather than just adding headcount," Joshi says.

At ₹20,272 crore, divestment mop up hits 4-year high in just over 3 months of FY27

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Disinvestment proceeds in just over three months of FY27 have already reached their highest level in four years, according to data from the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM).

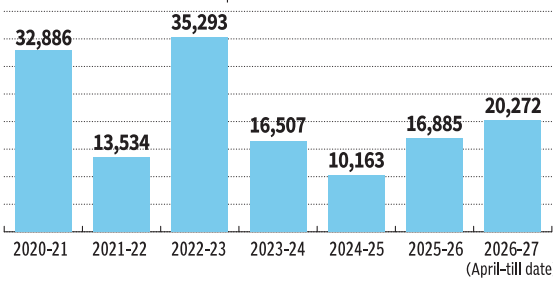
The government has completed seven offer-for-sale (OFS) transactions, raising over ₹20,000 crore.

SEVEN OFS DEALS

The stake sales include Central Bank of India (over ₹2,200 crore), Coal India (₹5,500 crore), NHPC (₹4,300 crore), NLC India (₹1,200 crore), GIC Re (₹3,000 crore), Indian Railway Finance Corporation (₹2,000 crore) and Cochin Shipyard (over ₹1,700 crore).

An OFS allows promoters or large shareholders of listed companies to sell shares

Disinvestment proceeds (₹ crore)



Source: DIPAM (Department of Investment and Public Asset Management)

through stock exchanges. It involves fewer regulatory requirements and can be executed much faster than an initial public offering or a follow-on public offer.

While the government has not disclosed its FY27 OFS pipeline, market expectations are that more are in the works, including a potential offering in LIC, select public sector banks and financial institutions.

The Centre is also considering listing the Export

Credit Guarantee Corporation and India Infrastructure Finance Company Ltd. Officials remained tight-lipped on the next listing, saying premature announcements could influence market prices.

REVENUE CUSHION

The Budget no longer uses the term "disinvestment", with such receipts now classified under Miscellaneous Capital Receipts (MCR).

For FY27, the government

has budgeted ₹80,000 crore under MCR, which includes proceeds from minority stake sales, strategic disinvestment, equity management and asset monetisation.

The government holds stake in 68 listed Central Public Sector Enterprises valued at over ₹22.8 lakh crore, besides investments of around ₹19 lakh crore in 16 listed public sector financial institutions, including banks and insurance companies. This provides ample headroom for minority stake sales, particularly as the government needs to cut holdings in several firms to comply with the 25 per cent minimum public shareholding norm.

The need to mobilise non-tax revenue has become more pressing as tax collections are expected to soften, while expenditure on items such as food and fertilizer subsidies could rise because of the continuing conflict in West Asia.

QUICKLY.

Wheels India plans to raise up to ₹400 crore



Chennai: The Board of Directors of Wheels India approved fundraising plans for an aggregate amount of up to ₹400 crore. The funds are to be raised by way of issuance of equity shares of face value ₹10 and/or equity linked instruments, including convertible preference shares and non-convertible debt instruments, along with warrants and other such modes in one or more tranches. This will be in one or more foreign markets and/or domestic markets through public/private offerings and/or rights offering, or also by way of preferential allotment, including qualified institutions placement. **OUR BUREAU**

Yamaha launches flex fuel version of FZ



Chennai: India Yamaha Motor has announced the launch of FZ-Blue Flex. Yamaha will introduce flex-fuel capability to the FZ line-up, and is engineered to run on ethanol-blended fuels ranging from E20 to E85. “Achieving a carbon-neutral future requires a dynamic, multi-pathway strategy rather than a single solution. Having already commenced our electric vehicle journey in India, the introduction of Blue Flex technology marks another strategic milestone,” said Hajime Aota, Chairman, Yamaha Motor India. **OUR BUREAU**

Financiers drive confidence as used EV market sees growth

A NEW TREND. Performance and long-term value of electric vehicles attract buyers

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Mandeep Kaur, a 28-year-old businessman from Gurugram, visited Autobest Emporio’s luxury pre-owned car showroom in West Delhi looking for a conventional luxury SUV such as an Audi Q5 or Range Rover Velar. Electric vehicles were not part of his purchase plan. However, after a short test drive in a pre-owned Mercedes-Benz EQE, he returned the following day and bought the electric luxury sedan.

Industry executives say such experiences are becoming increasingly common as buyers gain confidence in the performance, reliability and long-term value of electric vehicles. Financiers are also beginning to explore assured future-value financing to reduce resale uncertainty.

India’s pre-owned EV market is expected to grow 20-25 per cent over the next year after expanding to an estimated 8,000-12,000 transactions in FY26 from around 2,000-3,000 units in FY25, according to industry estimates and market participants.

The growth comes as the first wave of electric passenger vehicles sold in FY22 and FY23 begins entering the replacement cycle, creating a larger pool of vehicles for the secondary market.

EMERGING ASSET

Market participants believe financing innovation could become a key catalyst for the sector’s next phase of growth. Several lenders are evaluating assured future-value financing products for the pre-owned vehicle market, aimed at reducing uncertainty around residual values



IN TOP GEAR. Market participants believe financing innovation could become a key catalyst for the sector’s next phase of growth

and depreciation. Bajaj Finance is among the lenders evaluating such a product for the pre-owned car market, signalling that organised financiers now see used EVs as an emerging asset class.

Speaking to *businessline*, Avneet Singh Kohli, Founder of Delhi-based luxury pre-owned retailer Autobest Emporio, said growing interest from financiers reflects rising confidence in the segment.

“Customers buying their first premium car want to know today what it will be worth after three years. Financing products that provide more visibility on future value can significantly improve customer confidence and reduce concerns around depreciation,” said Kohli.

Until recently, banks and non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) largely focused on financing new EVs, while remaining cautious about used electric vehicles because of limited historical resale data, uncertainty around battery degradation and concerns over residual values.

That perception is beginning to change. Certified bat-

tery-health diagnostics, OEM-backed refurbishment programmes and digital service records are helping create greater transparency around vehicle condition and ownership history. Industry executives say these developments are making used EVs a more financeable asset class and attracting increased interest from lenders.

BENCHMARK PRICING

The emergence of benchmark pricing is another sign that the secondary EV market is maturing. A two-year-old Tata Nexon EV typically commands between ₹5.7 lakh and ₹9 lakh in the used-car market, while Tata Tiago EVs are selling for ₹5 lakh to ₹7.5 lakh. In the mid-premium category, MG ZS EVs are priced from around ₹9.8 lakh, while Mahindra XUV400 models change hands for ₹9.5 lakh to ₹13 lakh.

Luxury electric vehicles are also finding buyers. BMW iX models are currently listed between ₹48 lakh and ₹68 lakh, Audi e-tron and Q8 e-tron SUVs between ₹48 lakh and ₹72

lakh and Kia EV6 models between ₹30 lakh and ₹40 lakh. Dealers say vehicles backed by certified battery-health reports and transparent service histories can attract premiums of ₹40,000-70,000, compared to similar vehicles without such documentation.

Automakers and organised retailers are simultaneously investing in the ecosystem required to support long-term growth. Recently, JSW MG Motor India partnered with used-car platform Spinny to strengthen the country’s pre-owned EV market through battery-health certification, warranty continuity, transparent pricing and certified refurbishment standards.

Vinay Raina, Chief Commercial Officer at JSW MG Motor India, said a trusted pre-owned ecosystem would be critical for accelerating EV adoption in the country.

THE NEXT PHASE

Spinny founder and CEO Niraj Singh echoed the view, noting that the next phase of EV adoption will depend as much on customer trust as on technological improvements.

As more electric cars complete their first ownership cycle, industry executives believe that a combination of higher vehicle availability, reliable battery-health assessments, organised retail platforms and innovative financing solutions will determine how quickly India’s used EV market scales over the next few years. For financiers, the segment is increasingly emerging not as a niche category, but as a viable and growing asset class within the broader automotive market.

JSW: Next growth phase will be more demanding

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

JSW Cement said its next growth phase will be “larger and more demanding”, and the coming years will require simultaneously ramping up capacities, expanding into new markets and enhancing capacity utilisation, said MD Parth Jindal in the latest annual report.

The company will have to strengthen its ground-granulated blast furnace slag business, improve cost competitiveness, grow premium products, deepen digital adoption and accelerate sustainability. “Our next phase will be larger and more demanding. It will also be full of opportunity. India’s growth story needs cement companies that can scale responsibly. We are building ourselves for that role,” he said.

As investors chase mid-cap stocks, valuations get pricey

Saurabh Suryawanshi
Deepac Nishanth
Chennai

The relentless selling by foreign portfolio investors in the last couple of years has been largely concentrated in the large-cap stocks where the FPI holdings are higher.

Domestic investors have, therefore, been chasing mid- and small-cap stocks where the selling intensity is lower. This has resulted in mid-cap stocks being very expensive.

DATA FOCUS.

The Nifty Mid-cap 50 trades at nearly 34 times earnings against the Nifty 50’s 20 (P/E) and Nifty small-cap 50’s 32.4 (P/E). It is the costliest on price-to-book as well.

PRICIEST INDEX

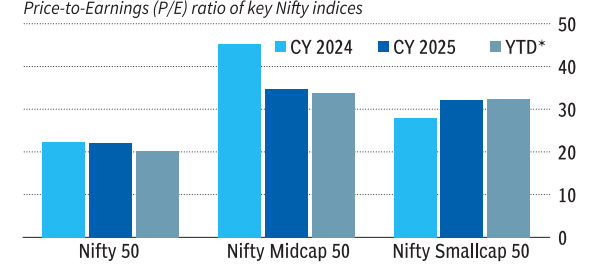
The reason for the Nifty Mid-cap 50’s premium is simple, and it is not profits. Over the past five years, the mid-cap index has returned close to 20 per cent annually, while its earnings have grown at only about 12 per cent, slower than the Nifty 50’s.

Vinod Nair, Head of Research at Geojit Investments, said: “Currently, mid-caps are trading at a premium valuation compared to large-caps. A stock-specific approach may be required to identify emerging themes and value opportunities within the mid-cap segment.” BHEL, which trades at a P/E far above peers on the strength of its ₹2.4 trillion order book, and Laurus Labs, at over 85 times earnings on expectations of strong growth in its CDMO business, capture the pattern.

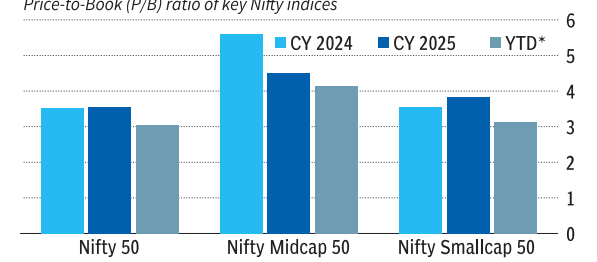
The year 2024 showed this most starkly. Mid-cap profits actually fell that year, yet the index still rose over 20 per cent, a gain built entirely on multiple expansion.

The bulls have a counter, and it is a fair one. Mid-cap earnings have surged nearly 50 per cent since 2024, and that has cooled the index’s price-to-earnings ratio from an extreme 45 to 34

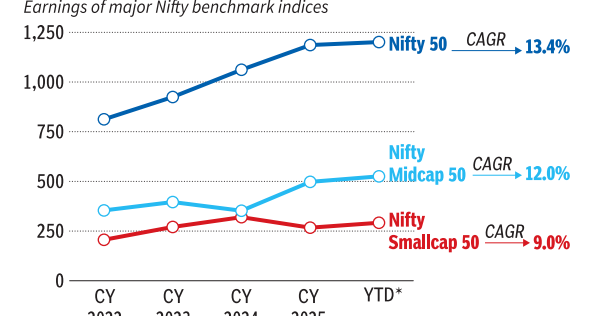
Rising risks in midcaps
Midcaps command the highest P/E valuation despite cooling since 2024



At 4.14 P/B, Nifty Midcap 50 sits as the market's most expensive index



Nifty Midcap 50 earnings hit a record 525.34 YTD



Midcaps give healthy returns, but volatility high too

Returns of major Nifty benchmark indices (in %)

INDEX	CY 2021	CY 2022	CY 2023	CY 2024	YTD*	CY 2025	CAGR	Volatility (SD)
Nifty 50	23.8	2.7	19.4	8.8	-7.2	10.1	10.8	6.6
Nifty Midcap 50	41.0	2.7	49.0	20.8	2.5	7.5	19.7	20.9
Nifty Smallcap 50	48.9	-19.8	62.6	24.6	11.3	-4.5	12.7	36.5

Source: Bloomberg *YTD till July 6, 2026

Mid-cap earnings have surged nearly 50% since 2024, and that has cooled the index's price-to-earnings ratio from an extreme 45 to 34

today’s price assumes the recent profit surge will continue uninterrupted. If earnings growth slips back towards its 12 per cent trend, the market will be left holding a premium it can no longer justify, and history suggests such gaps close

through falling prices.

“Small-caps, on the other hand, are not trading at similar premium levels and offer a relatively better investment opportunity, as they are currently trading at a discount to mid-caps. Meanwhile, large-caps are trading at more accommodative valuations, marginally below their long-term averages due to the significant impact of FII selling in 2025-26. As a result, they appear to offer the most attractive investment option from a risk-reward perspective,” explained Nair.

The writers are interns

‘Businesses must learn to turn the ship around’

Our Bureau
Chennai

In the current environment, being incrementally better is not enough and businesses must learn to turn the ship around, said Thomas Dose, Managing Director, BMW Group Plant Chennai.

‘MAKE IT SIMPLE’

“The best way to do that is to make it simple and not over complicate the task,” said Dose. “Do not listen to what management books and colleges have to say on this,” he added.

He was speaking at the Platinum Jubilee Annual General Meeting of the Madras Management Association (MMA) in Chennai. “We, in fact, turned around the Chennai [BMW] plant with this mantra,” said Dose.

Offering his key message to first-generation business owners, Dose, the chief guest



Jairam Varadaraj, MD, ELGI Equipments Ltd (third from left), receiving the Madras Management Association Award for Managerial Excellence from Thomas Dose, MD, BMW Group Plant Chennai, at the 70th AGM of MMA in Chennai on Friday **BIJAY GHOSH**

at the event, also asked them to figure out ways to instil the spirit of the founders to the next generation.

The event saw the MMA launch several special initiatives, including the Platinum Jubilee MMA Awards for Managerial Excellence, the Special Platinum Jubilee Issue

of *Business Mandate*, Volume 3 of *Turning Points: Management Lessons from Legends*, a Platinum Jubilee coffee table book and the Platinum Jubilee logo for the management association.

A key highlight of the evening was to honour companies with the 24th MMA

Awards for Managerial Excellence 2026.

VARIOUS WINNERS

ELGI Equipments Ltd, Apollo Hospitals, Indus Life Sciences Private Ltd and SSN College of Engineering were the winners across categories. The evening rounded off by honouring past presidents of the MMA, a distinguished line-up of the who’s who of Tamil Nadu’s business ecosystem.

MMA Managing Committee elected AR Unnikrishnan, Managing Director, Saint-Gobain India Pvt Ltd – Glass Group, as the President of MMA for 2026-27. MP Surya Prakas, Executive Director, Pon Pure Chemicals India Pvt Ltd, was elected Senior Vice-President, among other appointments.

The *Hindu* Group and *businessline* are the media partners for the MMA Awards for Managerial Excellence.

DGFT notifies procedure for cheaper UK car imports under new trade deal

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Ahead of the India-UK free trade agreement coming into force on July 15, India has notified the procedure for importers to seek approvals for quota-based import of passenger cars and goods vehicles at concessional import duties from the UK.

Under the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA), India has agreed to undertake a phased reduction of import duties on automotive imports, from around 110 per cent to 10 per cent, subject to agreed tariff quotas.

India has committed to allowing imports of up to 3.78 lakh conventional-engine passenger cars from the UK at the concessional duty over the first 15 years of the pact.

“Procedure for allocation of tariff rate quotas (TRQs) under India-UK (CETA) is notified... Only original

equipment manufacturers, dealers/channel partners duly authorised by the OEMs of vehicles originating in the UK shall be eligible to apply for the TRQ,” said the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) in a public notice dated July 9.

PRE-PURCHASE DEAL

At the time of clearance of the import consignment, the importer in India has to produce a certificate of origin issued by authorities in the UK, the notification specified.

To be eligible for the concessional duties, each applicant will have to submit a pre-purchase agreement issued by an OEM of the vehicles in the UK, setting out the quantity of vehicles agreed to be supplied to the applicant during the TRQ year.

“The year in respect of these imports will be the period from January 1 to December 31, the calendar

year in India. DGFT shall monitor the cumulative quantities for TRQ certificates issued. No TRQ certificates shall be issued once the stated TRQ quantity limit is reached,” it said. These certificates will be valid for a maximum period of 12 months or till the end of the calendar year, whichever is earlier.

“Importers under TRQ shall endeavour to pass on the benefit of the concessional customs duty available under the TRQ to the final buyer or consumer,” the notification clarified.

ICE CARS

For internal combustion engine (ICE) passenger cars, the in-quota customs duty for large vehicles (above 3,000 cc petrol and 2,500 cc diesel), which currently attract a base duty of 110 per cent, will be reduced from 30 per cent in the first year to 25 per cent in the second year, 20 per cent in the third year,

15 per cent in the fourth year and 10 per cent from the fifth year onwards.

For mid-sized and small ICE cars, where the base customs duty is 66 per cent, the concessional duty will fall from 50 per cent to 40 per cent in the first year, 30 per cent, 20 per cent and finally 10 per cent from fifth year onwards.

The annual quota for ICE passenger cars will rise from 20,000 units in the first year to a peak of 37,000 units in the fifth year before gradually declining, allowing the import of a cumulative 3,78,000 vehicles over the first 15 years.

HYBRID VEHICLES

A separate quota for electric, hybrid and hydrogen-powered passenger cars will come into effect from the sixth year, with annual volumes increasing from 4,400 units to 22,000 units by the fifteenth year.

Exide Industries to invest ₹1,400 crore in lithium-ion cell plant in Bengaluru

Our Bureau
Kolkata

Storage battery major Exide Industries said on Friday that it is planning to invest around ₹1,400 crore this fiscal for the first phase of the multi giga watt hour (GWh) greenfield lithium-ion cell manufacturing project in Bengaluru, which is expected to start generating revenues from the third quarter.

BATTERY SUPPLY

The company has already invested around ₹4,800 crore in the lithium-ion cell manufacturing plant in Bengaluru.

In a post-AGM media interaction, Exide Industries Managing Director and CEO Avik Roy said the company is looking to begin the supply of indigenous lithium-ion batteries to electric vehicle makers and energy storage players from Q3FY27.

“We expect revenue to

start flowing in from the Bengaluru plant by the third quarter of the current financial year. Initially, we will replace imported lithium iron phosphate cells for our Gujarat battery pack plant catering to the three-wheeler segment. By the end of the financial year, we also expect to start supplying for certain two-wheeler battery pack applications and nickel manganese cobalt cells for OEMs, subject to the homologation and approval process,” Roy told mediapersons.

He said the company expects to begin utilise around 3GWh of the Bengaluru plant’s 6 GWh first-phase capacity during this fiscal.

‘KEY MILESTONE’

“I am pleased to share that our giga factory in Bengaluru is progressing well towards operational readiness, with utility installations completed for all four lines. The



Avik Roy, Managing Director and CEO, Exide Industries

facility is designed for multiple chemistries, including LFP & NCM, and multiple form factors, including cylindrical and prismatic cells. In the first quarter of FY27, we dispatched samples from our factory, an important milestone for this business. These milestones give us confidence that we are moving in the right direction,” he told shareholders during the company’s annual general meeting.

Industry estimates project domestic demand for lithium-ion cells to rise to

around 130 GWh by 2030, of which nearly 100 GWh is expected to come from electric vehicles. Exide is targeting around ₹20,000 crore revenue by FY28 from its core lead-acid business. The company clocked standalone revenue of ₹17,269 crore in FY26, registering year-on-year growth of 4.1 per cent.

“We enter FY27 with confidence and optimism. The opportunities are encouraging across automotive OEM, automotive replacement, industrial UPS, railways, solar, data centres and infrastructure,” said Roy.

businessline.

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QUICKLY.

ONGC okays plan for oil reserve at Mangaluru



New Delhi: Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) on Friday said its board has given in-principle approval to develop a 1.75-million-tonne strategic petroleum reserve at Mangaluru, expanding India's emergency crude oil storage capacity. The project, along with associated facilities, will be developed as the Phase-I extension of the Mangaluru strategic petroleum reserve, the company said in a stock exchange filing. **PTI**

NTPC seeks to invest in overseas uranium assets

India's largest power producer is seeking to invest in overseas uranium mines to secure supplies needed to fuel 30 GW of nuclear power capacity it plans to build over the next two decades. State-controlled NTPC Ltd issued a tender to appoint consultants that will help identify potential assets in uranium-mining countries including Canada, Australia, Kazakhstan and South Africa, according to documents posted on its tender website. Bids are due July 16. **BLOOMBERG**

FTA, \$20 billion investment top Modi's New Zealand agenda

FAST-TRACKING DEALS. PM, Luxon to discuss trade pact rollout, visa pathway and defence co-operation

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's priorities during his New Zealand visit, which begins on Friday, include early ratification and implementation of the recently signed free trade agreement (FTA) and operationalising the \$20-billion investment pipeline. He is expected to begin discussions on these issues with New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon on Saturday.

The two leaders are also likely to review the proposed visa pathway for Indian professionals and students, which has encountered resistance within New Zealand's coalition government, with coalition partner New Zealand First raising concerns over immigration concessions.

Other agenda items include launching direct air connectivity, expanding maritime security cooperation, and deepening collaboration in defence, education, sports and culture, sources said.

Modi's visit — the first by an Indian Prime Minister to



DEEPENING TIES. Prime Minister Narendra Modi with New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon in Auckland on Friday **ANI**

New Zealand in four decades — marks the final leg of his three-nation tour, following visits to Indonesia and Australia.

Modi was received by Luxon at Auckland airport, where the leaders exchanged a warm embrace.

“Reached Auckland a short while ago. Thankful to Prime Minister Luxon for the welcome at the airport,” Modi posted on X, describing the visit as “historic” and

saying he looked forward to discussing the full spectrum of India-New Zealand ties before addressing the Indian community in Auckland on Saturday.

TRADE TIES BOOST For India, the FTA, signed in April, provides duty-free access for all exports to New Zealand, benefiting labour-intensive sectors such as textiles, leather and marine products, while also opening

New Zealand's services market to Indian IT, education and professional services.

In return, India has agreed to reduce tariffs on most imports from New Zealand, while safeguarding sensitive sectors such as dairy.

New Zealand has separately committed to invest up to \$20 billion in India over the next 15 years, backed by a dedicated single-window mechanism to fast-track approvals. Luxon said on

Luxon said 57% of New Zealand's exports to India would become tariff-free from the first day of the FTA's implementation

Thursday that 57 per cent of New Zealand's exports to India would become tariff-free from the first day of the FTA's implementation, providing a major boost to Kiwi businesses.

BEYOND TRADE The leaders are also expected to discuss defence co-operation, maritime security and agri-tech collaboration. Modi will depart New Zealand on Saturday evening, concluding his three-nation diplomatic outreach.

UNTAPPED POTENTIAL Despite close political ties, bilateral trade remains modest at \$1.15 billion in FY26. Both countries expect the FTA to unlock significantly greater trade and investment flows in the coming years.

Economy resilient despite W. Asia war, but risks persist: Global institutions

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The global economy has remained broadly resilient despite the shock from the war in West Asia, but uncertainty continues to cloud the outlook even as fuel and fertilizer prices have eased over the past month, the heads of the International Energy Agency (IEA), International Monetary Fund (IMF), World Bank Group (WBG) and World Trade Organization (WTO) have said.

In a joint statement put out by WTO Director General Ngozi Okonjo Iweala following a meeting of the high-level coordination group on July 7, the four institutions said the decline in fuel and fertilizer prices since their previous meeting in June had helped ease some of the inflationary pressures triggered by the conflict.

However, they cautioned that the war's economic impact could linger, with energy markets still under strain and the movement of goods through key trade routes continuing to face disruptions. “We encourage fur-



IEA, IMF, World Bank and WTO said they would continue to closely monitor developments in energy and trade

ther progress toward a resolution to the conflict and the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz. Fuel and fertilizer prices dropped since we last met in June. However, uncertainty remains high, and the impact of the war could linger. Energy markets and transit of goods are still facing strains,” the joint statement underlined.

The institutions urged governments and the international community to remain vigilant and work together to uphold the principle of freedom of navigation in the Strait of Hor-

muz and globally, support economic recovery, protect jobs and livelihoods, strengthen energy and food security, including through improving port infrastructure and trade facilitation, and build broader resilience to future shocks.

On a positive note, the institutions said the world economy had weathered the crisis better than initially feared, although several economies had experienced slower growth and higher inflation. The assessment comes after months of turmoil in global shipping following disruptions through the Strait of Hormuz, which drove up freight and insurance costs and raised fears over energy supplies and inflation worldwide. Although an initial US-Iran peace deal has improved the situation somewhat, the situation is delicate as the two sides continue to trade charges.

The IEA, IMF, World Bank and WTO said they would continue to closely monitor developments in energy, trade and the global economy while coordinating support for countries most affected by the crisis.

Forex kitty rises to \$674 billion

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

The country's forex reserves jumped \$7.26 billion to \$674.193 billion during the week ended July 3, the Reserve Bank of India said on Friday.

In the previous reporting week, the forex kitty had dropped by \$5.654 billion to \$666.933 billion.

The kitty had expanded to an all-time high of \$ 728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year before the onset of the West Asia conflict, which led to several weeks of a drop as the rupee came under pressure and the RBI had to intervene in the forex market through dollar sales.

For the week ended July 3, foreign currency asset increased \$4.51 billion to \$545.578 billion.

Value of gold reserves jumped \$2.669 billion to \$105.205 billion during the week, the RBI said. Special drawing rights were up \$65 million at \$18.623 billion, the apex bank said.

India's reserve position with the IMF was also up by \$15 million to \$4.787 billion.

Good support for ‘One Nation, One Election’, may happen by 2029, says JPC chief

Press Trust of India
Panaji

The Joint Committee of Parliament examining the Bills on simultaneous elections is working to create a mechanism that could make the ‘One Nation, One Election’ reform fully operational by the 2029 general elections, its chairperson PP Chaudhary said on Friday.

FULL SUPPORT

Speaking to reporters on the sidelines of the panel's two-day meeting in Goa, Chaudhary claimed that nearly 99 per cent of civil society stakeholders consulted so far have backed the proposal, which aims to curb an estimated ₹7-lakh crore economic loss caused by frequent polls.

The Committee began its deliberations in Goa on the Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill, 2024, with an interaction with Chief Minister Pramod Sawant and members of his Cabinet, seeking their views on the challenges involved in implementing simultaneous elections and ways to address them. “We had an informal interaction with the Chief

Minister and Cabinet ministers, who represent the people of Goa. We discussed how ‘One Nation, One Election’ can be implemented, the challenges and how they can be mitigated while maintaining a fine balance acceptable to all,” Chaudhary said.

VISITS STATES

He said that the Committee has visited several States, including Gujarat, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Punjab, Haryana and Delhi, and interacted with constitutional experts, civil society organisations, educationists and other stakeholders.

An overwhelming majority of those consulted support the idea of simultaneous elections, said the BJP MP from Pali in Rajasthan.

“We have found that almost 99 per cent of stakeholders, particularly from civil society and various organisations, favour simultaneous elections. The effort now is to evolve a mechanism that is acceptable to all political parties,” he said.

Asked about the timeline for implementation, he said the Committee was examining various options, indicat-



PP Chaudhary

ing that the reform could become operational by the time the next general elections are due in 2029. He said there is also a possibility of bringing some States into alignment before that if political parties and the Chief Ministers voluntarily agree to synchronise their election cycles.

Highlighting the economic rationale behind the proposal, Chaudhary cited findings placed before the high-level committee headed by former President Ram Nath Kovind. He said that an economic study submitted to the Kovind Committee estimated that holding elections separately across the country results in an economic loss of nearly ₹7-lakh crore, while synchronised elections could generate equivalent gains for

the national economy. “Elections are now not confined to one State. If elections are held anywhere in the country, they have an impact on other States because the economy is interconnected,” Chaudhary said.

Using Goa as an example, he said that elections in any major State affect tourist arrivals in Goa, while elections in the coastal State itself impact its tourism industry.

The BJP MP also argued that repeated elections disrupt governance and affect education, as teachers are routinely deployed for election duties, including preparation of electoral rolls, training and polling work.

“As a result, teaching in government schools suffers. The worst affected are children from economically weaker sections who depend on government schools. This is a serious concern if the situation continues over the coming decades,” he said.

Chaudhary described simultaneous elections as a “major electoral reform” envisioned by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, saying it would help the country achieve its goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047.

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NOTICE OF 74TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND REMOTE E-VOTING

Notice is hereby given that the **74th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Company will be held on Tuesday, August 11, 2026 at 11:00 a.m. at Taj MG Road, 41/3, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Bengaluru-560001** to transact the Business as set out in the Notice of 74th AGM.

Notice of the 74th AGM setting out the business to be transacted thereat, along with Proxy Form, Annual Report of the Company for the year ended March 31, 2026 have been sent in electronic mode on **July 10, 2026** to the members whose e-mail IDs are registered with the Company or Depository Participant(s). Letter providing weblink and exact path of annual report for financial year 2025-26 is being dispatched to those shareholders who have not registered their e-mail IDs with the company / DP's

The notice of the 74th AGM including Attendance slip and Annual Report for Financial year 2025-26 is also available on the Company's website at www.bosch.in under Shareholder Information and stock exchange websites i.e., www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com. 74th AGM notice is also available at www.evotingindia.com on the website of the Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL).

The Link to access the full Annual Report 2026 of the Company is https://www.bosch.in/media/our_company/shareholder_information/2026/bosch_annual_report_2025-26.pdf

Pursuant to the provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 (the Act) read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended, Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 and the Secretarial Standard on General Meetings issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India, the Company is providing the facility to its members holding equity shares either in physical form or dematerialized form, as on **Tuesday, August 4, 2026 (cut-off date)**, for casting their votes electronically on each item as set forth in the Notice of 74th AGM through the electronic voting system provided by Central Depository Services (India) Limited from a place other than the venue of the AGM (remote e-voting).

All members are hereby informed that:

1. The ordinary and special business as set out in the Notice of 74th AGM may be transacted through voting by electronic means;
2. Date of completion of dispatch of Notice of AGM and Annual Report: July 10, 2026;
3. The remote e-voting shall commence on Friday, August 7, 2026, at 9.00 a.m (IST);
4. The remote e-voting shall end on Monday, August 10, 2026, at 5.00 p.m. (IST);
5. The remote e-voting shall not be allowed beyond 5.00 p.m. (IST) on Monday, August 10, 2026;
6. The cut-off date for determining the eligibility to vote through remote e-voting or at the AGM will be Tuesday, August 4, 2026;

Any person, who acquires the shares of the Company and becomes a Member of Company after dispatch of Notice of AGM and holds shares as of cut-off date i.e. August 4, 2026 may obtain the Login ID and password by sending a request to the Company or its RTA at the address/email IDs given under the table below. However, if the Member is already registered with CDSL for remote e-voting, then such Member shall use the existing User ID and password for casting his/her vote;

The facility for voting through "electronic voting system" shall be made available at the venue of the AGM and the Members attending the meeting, who have not cast their vote by remote e-voting, shall also be eligible to exercise their right to cast their vote at the meeting through "electronic voting system";

The Members who have cast their vote through remote e-voting prior to the AGM may also attend the AGM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again at the meeting;

A person, whose name is registered in the Register of Members or in the register of beneficial owners maintained by the depositories as on the cut-off date i.e. August 4, 2026 only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting or voting through "electronic voting system" at the AGM;

Shareholders holding shares in physical form (who have not registered their e-mail address) are requested to furnish their e-mail addresses and mobile numbers with the Company's RTA viz. Integrated Registry Management Services Private Limited;

Members holding shares who have not registered their e-mail addresses with the Company can cast their vote through remote e-voting or e-voting at the AGM by following the below process for obtaining the e-voting credentials:

- a) In case of shares held in physical form, please provide copy of the signed request letter mentioning the Folio Number, name and address of the shareholder, scanned copy of the share certificate (front and back), Self attested copy of the PAN card and self-attested copy of any document (e.g. Driving License, Election Identity Card, Passport) in support of the address of the shareholder by email to RTA E-mail Id: irg@integratedindia.in or to the Company E-mail Id: secretarial.corp@in.bosch.com
- b) In case of shares held in demat form, please provide Demat account details (CDSL:- 16 digit beneficiary ID or NSDL:- 16 digit DPID + CLID), Name of shareholder, client master or copy of consolidated Account statement, Self-attested copy of the PAN card by email to irg@integratedindia.in or to the Company E-mail Id: secretarial.corp@in.bosch.com

In case of any queries, the members may call on the toll-free no. 1800-210-9911. Members may also contact:

Particulars	Central Depository Services (India) Limited	Integrated Registry Management Services Private Limited	Bosch Limited
Address	A-wing, 25 th floor, Marathon Futrex, Mafatal mill compound, NM Joshi Marg, Lower Parel east, Mumbai - 400013	No. 30, Ramana Residency 4th Cross, Sampige Road, Malleswaram, Bengaluru 560 003	Hosur Road, Adugodi, Bengaluru - 560 030
Name & Designation	Mr. Rakesh Dalvi (Senior Manager)	Mr. Harish K (Assistant General Manager)	Mr. V Srinivasan (Company Secretary and Compliance Officer)
Phone	1800-210-9911	(080) 23460815 to 818	+91 9262105247
E-mail	helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com	irg@integratedindia.in	secretarial.corp@in.bosch.com

Dividend and Record Date:

Members may note that the Board of Directors at its meeting held on May 20, 2026, have recommended a final dividend of INR 270/- per equity share of Rs. 10 /-each, subject to approval of the shareholders. The record date for the purpose of determining entitlement of shareholders for the final dividend is Tuesday, August 4, 2026. The final dividend once approved by the members at the 74th AGM, will be paid on or after August 14, 2026. The said notice may be accessed on the Company's website www.bosch.in under "Shareholder Information"

By order of the Board
Sd/-
V. Srinivasan
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Place : Bengaluru
Date : July 10, 2026

CM
YK

QUICKLY.

PFC raises \$300 m via floating rate bonds



New Delhi: State-owned Power Finance Corporation (PFC) on Friday said it has raised \$300 million through bonds carrying floating interest rates. The net proceeds from the issuance of these Notes will be used in accordance with the external commercial borrowing guidelines of the Reserve Bank of India, an exchange filing said. PTI

Weighing strategy for India assets: SMFG

Sumitomo Mitsui Financial Group Inc is evaluating its India strategy as it looks for ways to consolidate its presence in one of the world's fastest-growing banking markets, people with knowledge of the matter said. SMFG is studying ways to streamline its various operations in the country and may seek to conduct its Indian business primarily through Yes Bank Ltd. BLOOMBERG

Indian Bank Q1 profit up 10% at ₹3,273 cr on all-round growth

GOOD SHOW. Net interest income jumps 17% to ₹7,435 crore; asset quality improves

Our Bureau
Chennai

Public sector lender Indian Bank on Friday reported a 10 per cent rise in net profit to ₹3,273 crore in the first quarter of FY27 (Q1FY27) on growth of business.

The Chennai-headquartered lender also saw an improvement in asset quality.

Indian Bank reported a total income of ₹20,724 crore during the quarter, up from ₹18,721 crore in the same quarter of FY26. Net interest income increased 16.9 per cent y-o-y to ₹7,435 crore in the quarter ended June 2026.

Domestic net interest margin (NIM) improved to 3.41 per cent in June 2026 from 3.35 per cent in June 2025.

Total business increased 13.7 per cent, reflecting broad-based momentum across operations.

Total RAM (retail, agriculture & MSME) advances



Q1 Scorecard (₹ crore)

	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	Growth (%)
Net profit	2,973	3,273	10.1
Gross advances	6,01,147	6,84,623	13.9
Total deposits	7,44,289	8,44,578	13.5
Gross NPA %	3.01	1.86	-115 bps
Net NPA %	0.18	0.15	-3 bps

grew 14.8 per cent y-o-y to ₹4,16,992 crore driven by growth of 18.7 per cent and 17 per cent, respectively, in retail and MSME loans. Total deposits increased 13.5 per cent y-o-y and reached to ₹8,44,578 crore as of June 2026, with a 15.3 per cent y-o-y growth in CASA.

PROFIT DRIVERS

“We have beat our own guidance across all parameters,”

Binod Kumar, MD & CEO, Indian Bank, told mediapersons. He flagged the growth in CASA and in RAM advances as key drivers of profit. CASA growth, especially, has come from a variety of initiatives the bank has taken in recent months, including the set up of a next-gen call centre.

“Around 17 lakh inoperative accounts have been converted to operative accounts

this quarter and this has brought in about ₹1,469 crore of balances,” he said.

Power, infrastructure and data centre sectors are aiding the overall corporate credit growth of Indian Bank, which saw a 11.5 per cent y-o-y increase in Q1FY27.

Retail loans was led by housing and auto loans and agri segment slowed as jewel loans tapered.

The bank's asset quality showed improvement as gross non-performing assets (NPAs) declined to 1.86 per cent of gross advances at the end of the June quarter from 3 per cent a year ago.

Similarly, net NPAs, or bad loans, declined to 0.15 per cent, against 0.18 per cent in the year-ago period.

Total business of around ₹67,327 crore has been generated through digital channels during Q1FY27, the bank said in a statement.

The number of mobile banking users has grown 22 per cent y-o-y, reaching 2.48 crore users.

Indian Bank raises \$140 m in FCNR (B) deposits post new RBI rule

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Indian Bank has raised around \$140 million in fresh FCNR (B) deposits till date from the time the new RBI swap window kicked in, in the month of June.

OPTIMISTIC GOAL

“My plan is to raise around \$2 billion in FCNR (B) deposits till September. It may seem high but I already have a pipeline of \$1 billion visible,” Binod Kumar, Managing Director and CEO, Indian Bank, told select mediapersons on Friday, after the earnings.

Indian Bank currently offers a rate of interest of 6 per cent on such FCNR (B) deposits. In comparison to fresh flows of \$140 million, the bank had an outstanding balance of around \$457 million in FCNR (B) accounts as of March 2026.

FOREX SWAP

Prior to this, the MD and CEO said the public sector bank saw such a jump back in



Binod Kumar, MD & CEO, Indian Bank

2013, when such a scheme came.

The Reserve Bank of India has introduced a special forex swap window for FCNR (B) deposits to attract foreign currency and strengthen reserves. This went live on June 8 and started to be effective at banks a few days from then, and is operative till September 30, 2026, for 3-5 year maturities.

These guidelines allow banks to offer higher interest rates (up to 7.1 per cent) by removing interest rate caps and provide exemptions from CRR/SLR requirements.

Bank of Maharashtra Q1 profit up 27%

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Bank of Maharashtra (BoM) reported a 27 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) increase in first quarter (Q1FY27) standalone net profit at ₹2,020 crore on the back of a healthy growth in net interest income as well as non-interest income, even as its net interest margin saw a dip.

The Pune-headquartered public sector bank had logged at net profit of ₹1,593 crore in the year ago (Q1FY26) period.

While the net interest margin (NIM) declined to 3.79 per cent in Q1FY27 from 3.91 per cent in the preceding quarter and 3.95 per cent in Q1FY26, MD & CEO Nidhu Saxena emphasised

that the NIM is above the FY27 guidance of 3.75 per cent.

FCNR (B) OPPORTUNITY

In a media interaction, Saxena noted the RBI's limited period window for mobilising FCNR (B) at a higher interest rate presents an attractive opportunity for re-source mobilisation and the bank is developing dedicated FCNR (B) products.

He emphasised that BoM's FCNR (B) rates of up to 6.60 per cent are among the most competitive being offered by public sector banks.

In the reporting quarter, BoM's net interest income (difference between interest earned and interest expended) was up 14.53 per cent y-o-y at ₹3,770 crore (₹3,292 crore in the year ago period).

Non-interest income, including fee-based income, treasury income and recovery in written-off accounts, rose 25 per cent y-o-y to ₹1,029 crore (₹825 crore).

STRONG QUARTER

Gross non-performing assets (GNPAs) position improved to 1.45 per cent of gross advances as at June-end 2026 against 1.74 per cent as at June-end 2025. Net NPAs position too improved a shade to 0.13 per cent of net advances against 0.18 per cent.

Global advances increased 26.90 per cent y-o-y to ₹3,05,964 crore as at June-end 2026 on the back of 28.94 per cent growth in agriculture advances, retail advances (24.59 per cent), MSME advances (23.17 per

cent) and corporate & other advances (20.97 per cent).

On credit extended to MSMEs under the emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS), Saxena out of the ₹6,500 crore worth of eligible advances, the bank has extended credit to MSMEs aggregating ₹3,100 crore and ₹400 crore to corporates so far.

Total deposits rose 12.93 per cent y-o-y to stand at ₹3,44,493 crore as at June-end 2026. Low-cost CASA (current account, savings account) deposits declined a share to 49 per cent of total deposits against 50 per cent in the year ago quarter.

BoM shares closed at ₹84.35 apiece, up 2.87 per cent over the previous close on BSE.

SBI Funds Management raises ₹1,655 crore through pre-IPO placement priced at ₹545-₹574/share

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SBI Funds Management, the largest asset management company in India, has raised ₹1,655 crore through pre-IPO (Initial Public Offering) placement on Friday.

The fund house has undertaken a private placement of 2,88,32,748 equity shares for cash considerations at an issue price of ₹574 per equity share which saw participation from 3P India Equity Fund 1, Tata AIG General Insurance Company, Dymon Asia Multi-Strategy Investment (Singapore) and Bennett Coleman & Co, amongst others.

3P India Equity Fund 1



The retail subscription will open on July 14 REUTERS

was allocated 26,13,240 equity shares of the company for ₹574 per equity share each aggregating to ₹150 crore. Tata AIG General Insurance was allocated 17,42,160 equity shares worth ₹100 crore.

Dymon Asia Multi-

Strategy Investment (Singapore) was allocated 4,35,540 equity shares worth ₹25 crore. Bennett Coleman & Co picked up 8,71,080 shares worth ₹50 crore.

SBI Funds Management has priced its initial public offering at ₹545 to ₹574 per

TVS Venu's Atelier Expressions to acquire majority stake in Khoya

Our Bureau
Chennai

Atelier Expressions, the premium lifestyle platform of TVS Venu group, has entered into an agreement to acquire a majority stake in Lonestar Hospitality Private Ltd (Khoya), the New Delhi-based luxury handcrafted mithai brand.

The acquisition, subject to customary closing conditions, is expected to be completed at the end of August 2026.

Khoya to join Atelier Expressions' premium lifestyle portfolio “Khoya reflects the qualities we look for at Atelier Expressions, and we look forward to working together to build on its success while preserving the authenticity and character that define the brand,” said Tara Venu, Executive Director of Atelier Expressions.

“This partnership with Atelier Expressions offers a tremendous opportunity to scale our presence across India, explore new collaborations and elevate Khoya to greater success,” Sid Mathur, Founder of Khoya, said.

Optimal strategy in US trade deal is to focus on patience over relationship preservation: SBI

Our Bureau
Mumbai

India's optimal strategy to get the best trade deal with the US is to wear down the opening position, not the relationship, said State Bank of India (SBI) economists.

In a report, the economists noted that India sits between NATO allies and China — “it does not have China's concentrated chokehold, but it has meaningful leverage: market scale, pharmaceuticals, energy optionality... diaspora influence.”

They suggested that India should keep the conversation warm, avoid public escalation, make limited and reversible offers, and wait for the US administration's first

demand to run into US market costs, China-balancing needs and alliance fatigue. Then bargain late, when Washington's reservation price is clearer and India's value as a market, technology partner, defence buyer and Indo-Pacific counterweight is more visible.

THE RIGHT MOVE

“India's strategy should be to test the resolve of the US Administration and potentially accept a high cost follow-through in the short run, and signal that India stands its ground for the long game... Dive sideways and test the resolve... India will win...,” said Soumya Kanti Ghosh, Group Chief Economic Adviser, SBI.

The SBI report noted that

the US Administration is using uncertainty as a bargaining instrument across NATO, Iran, tariffs, Greenland, China and also India.

“In this context, the other side must decide whether to concede, wait, test, or counter-escalate. The short-run payoff is leverage. The long-run cost is trust depreciation with the US. Interestingly, such repeated uncertainties also teaches allies, rivals and markets to discount future signals,” the economists said.

Alternatively, if every partner learns that the final US position will be adjusted when costs rise, the bargaining value of the signal declines.

The economists observed that China sits at the top of

the architecture because it has credible counter-leverage: critical minerals, rare-earth magnets, manufacturing depth, export controls and supply-chain pressure. So, the US administration must calibrate differently with China because Beijing can impose real costs.

Shipping data through the Strait of Hormuz shows only limited and uneven signs of restarting. There has only been a gradual return of flows, rather than a broad normalisation of traffic.

The economists said while crude flows have restarted in a limited way, agricultural inbound shipments show only a tentative and incomplete recovery, but LNG and fertilizer-related shipments remain effectively absent.

Yes Bank: Positive upgrades signal stronger credit profile

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Yes Bank on Friday said the series of positive rating actions from domestic and international credit rating agencies reflect the sustained strengthening of its credit profile.

CONSISTENT RATING

S&P Global Ratings has assigned the private sector bank an inaugural long-term issuer credit rating of ‘BB+’ with a Stable outlook. This rating is consistent with the ‘Ba1’ (Stable) that Moody's Rating had assigned while upgrading the bank from ‘Ba2’ in May 2026, it said in a statement.

Life insurance savings biz in Q1 hit by West Asia uncertainties

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata



Emkay Research said the country's life insurance industry is expected to report around 11-12% retail APE growth this fiscal

around 16 per cent retail APE growth for the industry.

The industry reported a healthy 16 per cent year-on-year retail APE growth in June this year, supported by a strong 21 per cent retail APE growth by LIC and the private sector growing around 14 per cent.

“On a 2Y CAGR basis, the private sector clocked 13 per cent retail APE growth, while LIC reported around 11 per cent retail APE growth, driving 12.6 per cent retail APE

growth for the industry,” Emkay Research said.

Group APE for the industry grew at a strong 56 per cent y-o-y in June, 2026, driven by robust 92 per cent growth for the private sector, while LIC clocked around 31 per cent growth.

TOP PERFORMER

According to the report, among private listed players, SBI Life Insurance remained the top performer in June, clocking strong 18 per cent

y-o-y retail APE growth, followed by Axis Max Life Insurance at around 15 per cent. The healthy performance of SBI Life Insurance and Axis Max Life Insurance came on a strong base.

“ICICI Pru Life clocked 13 per cent y-o-y RWRP (retail weighted received premium) growth, while its retail APE grew at a modest 9.6 per cent in June, 2026. HDFC Life saw muted performance in June, reporting a 0.4 per cent decline in Retail APE, owing to the slowdown in the HDFC Bank channel. Canara HSBC Life clocked robust 28 per cent y-o-y retail APE growth on a strong base,” the report said.

STRONG START

Emkay Research said the country's life insurance industry is expected to report around 11-12 per cent retail APE growth this fiscal, sup-

ported by around 13-14 per cent growth for the private sector, while LIC is expected to deliver around 6-7 per cent retail APE growth.

India's life insurance industry reported a strong start to FY27, with new business premiums increasing 16.6 per cent y-o-y in Q1FY27, reflecting sustained demand across both retail and group segments, CareEdge Ratings said in a report on Thursday.

The growth was primarily driven by private insurers supported by continued traction in retail products and a recovery in group business, CareEdge said. “Industry APE also maintained strong momentum in Q1FY27, rising 23.4 per cent y-o-y. Growth was led by private insurers, whose APE increased 27.6 per cent y-o-y, while LIC recorded a healthy 16.8 per cent increase,” it added.

QUICKLY.

Tata AMC elevates Anand Vardarajan to MD & CEO



Mumbai: Tata Asset Management, the investment manager of Tata Mutual Fund, has appointed Anand Vardarajan as Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director with immediate effect as Prathibhobhe, the existing CEO and MD stepped down on July 7. Vardarajan has been an integral part of Tata Asset Management's leadership team since 2018 and served as Chief Business Officer. With over 24 years of experience in banking, wealth management and financial services, he has played a key role in driving business growth for the company. As part of the leadership transition, Hemant Kumar has been appointed CBO and will oversee business functions across the company verticals. OUR BUREAU

SK Hynix's ADR lists at \$170, 14% above IPO price

SK Hynix's US-listed shares opened at \$170, a premium of 14 per cent above the offering price of \$149 in their Nasdaq debut, signalling continued strength in investor appetite for companies benefiting from the AI boom. The offering is set to be the world's biggest share sale after SpaceX's record-breaking IPO last month. The chipmaker raised about \$26.5 billion on Thursday, by selling its American Depositary Receipts priced at \$149 apiece. Chipmakers have been among the biggest beneficiaries of this year's AI-driven rally, fuelled by expectations of heavy spending by hyperscalers. But concerns over stretched valuations and profit taking have recently injected volatility into the sector. REUTERS

BROKER'S CALL.

PL Capital

DR REDDY'S LAB (ACCUMULATE)
Target: ₹1,400
CMP: ₹1,245.50
Dr Reddy's Laboratories gets temporary setback with stoppage of Semaglutide supplies due to impurity issues associated with API. The next step will be company revalidating process again and testing which should be completed by Sept/Oct 2026; post that commercial supplies may resume. The company may recognise an inventory write-down on the affected batches however no product recalls. Currently there are only two generic players (Dr Reddy's and Apotex) which have got an approval. We believe there are more 4-5 players towards getting approval. Any delay in commercial supply from Dr Reddy's will take away first mover advantage. There is no need to submit any documents to Canadian regulator or others as validation batches is a scale up process and does not change the specification. Our FY27E stands cut by 5 per cent while FY28E largely remains unchanged. We have factor in \$180 million of sales from Sema in FY28. The company has been reporting an OPM at 15-16 per cent ex gRevlimid. Scale up in Sema along with reducing opex will be key to achieved 19-20 per cent OPM. Further timely launches like bAbatacept can accelerate profitability from H2-FY28E. We maintain our Accumulate rating on stock with TP of ₹1,400/share (23x FY28E EPS). Delay in re-entry of Semaglutide beyond H2FY27 will be key risk to our call.

JM Financial

SWIGGY (REDUCE)
Target: ₹250
CMP: ₹273.10
As per an exchange filing, Swiggy's aggregate foreign shareholding has declined to about 49.76 per cent, falling below the 50 per cent threshold for the first time. Although this is a key pre-requisite for qualifying as an Indian-Owned-and-Controlled Company (IOCC) under FEMA, it is not sufficient by itself; Swiggy will also need to complete the requisite governance changes, including demonstrating that ownership and control vest with resident Indian citizens/entities. As per our reading of official requirements, the test for IOCC eligibility is based on the ownership and control position at end-March of the previous fiscal year. Consequently, even if the required governance changes and foreign shareholding cap are completed over the next few months, IOCC transition is unlikely to happen before end-Mar'27. This in turn, would push out Instamart's transition to an inventory-led model as per our understanding to April 27 (at the earliest). We continue to ascribe zero value to Instamart, supply chain and platform innovation segments given the lack of visibility on a turnaround and the increasing probability of prolonged value destruction. We also exclude cash from our valuation, as continued losses will only deplete the balance of ₹15,000 crore each passing quarter. We continue to value the FD business at 35x adjusted EBITDA and the out-of-home segment at 25x EV/adjusted EBITDA, yielding a Jun'27E TP of ₹250.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

Mutual fund equity inflows jump 26% even as market remains volatile

CONSISTENT FAITH. SIP inflows stay above the ₹30,000-crore mark for fourth consecutive month

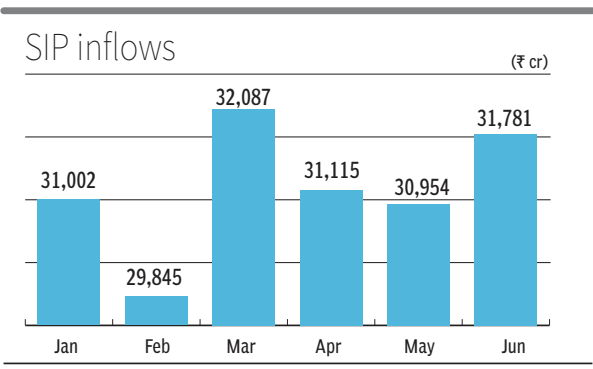
Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Inflows into equity mutual funds increased 26 per cent to ₹28,973 crore against ₹22,908 crore logged in the same period last year, even as the markets remained most volatile with upward bias. Similarly, gold exchange traded funds also attracted investment of ₹3,443 crore against an outflow of ₹725 crore in the previous month. Investment in silver jumped to ₹4,286 crore against an outflow of ₹2,133 crore in May, according to the Association of Mutual Funds in India data released on Friday.

Among equity schemes, mid- and small-cap schemes hogged the limelight with inflow of ₹6,090 crore (₹4,385

crore) and ₹5,602 crore (₹4,946 crore). Systematic investment plan registered an inflow of ₹31,781 crore (₹30,954 crore) with the contribution accounts increasing to 9.78 crore (9.64 crore).

DEBTS SEE OUTFLOW
However, debt funds recorded a net outflow of ₹1.09 lakh crore against an outflow of ₹96,949 crore due to redemption to meet quarter-end tax liability. Overall, the industry recorded an outflow of ₹52,949 crore against outflow of ₹64,021 crore. The asset under management was up to ₹82.22 lakh crore (₹81.58 lakh crore). Venkat Chalasani, Chief Executive, AMFI, said the consistent SIP inflows des-



pite volatile markets reflect growing investor confidence. While the geopolitical remains a headwinds, the prospects of domestic economy appear bright with growing consumption leading to better corporate earnings, he added. Varun Gupta, CEO, Groww Mutual Fund, said the negative net figure was a function of seasonal debt outflows rather than any weakening of investor appetite for equities. Continued interest in mid caps, small caps, flexi caps, arbitrage and multi asset strategies indicates that investors remain

focused on long-term wealth creation, looking past near-term market movements and liquidity-driven fluctuations, he added. Suranjana Borthakur, Head of Distribution & Strategic Alliances, Mirae Asset Investment Managers (India), said the data underscores a broader trend that retail investors continue to embrace disciplined investing and portfolio diversification. Umesh Sharma, CIO-Debt, The Wealth Company MF, said hybrid scheme inflows increased to ₹12,893 crore (₹10,560 crore), led by robust demand for arbitrage and multi-asset allocation categories as investors preferred diversified, lower-volatility strategies amid broader market shifts.

SEBI widens scope of intra-day borrowing facility for MFs

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

SEBI on Friday expanded the scope of intra-day borrowing by mutual funds, allowing asset management companies to use such facilities for a wider range of cash management needs arising from settlement timing mismatches. The revised framework, which comes into effect from September 1, follows amendments to the SEBI (Mutual Funds) Regulations, 2026. Earlier, MFs were permitted to borrow only to meet temporary liquidity needs for redemption and other unit holder payouts. Under the revised frame-

work, SEBI has allowed intra-day borrowings for 'pay-in with respect to investments made by the scheme', 'MTM (mark-to-market) obligations and foreign exchange settlements', and 'repayment of existing borrowings' in addition to unit holder payouts. The move is aimed at addressing liquidity mismatches caused by differences in market settlement timings, SEBI said. Intra-day borrowing can be availed against receivables expected during the day, including guaranteed inflows such as funds from the RBI, clearing corporations and subscription proceeds received in scheme bank accounts.

Edelweiss Mutual Fund stops fresh inflow in 7 overseas schemes

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Edelweiss Asset Management Company has stopped fresh registration of systematic investment plan (SIPs) and systematic transfer plans (STPs) in seven of its overseas focused funds from Friday as it has neared the limit set by the Association of Mutual Funds in India. The seven schemes are Edelweiss ASEAN Equity Off-shore Fund, Greater China Equity Off shore fund, US Technology Equity FoF, Emerging Markets Opportunities Equity Offshore Fund, Europe Dynamic

Equity Offshore Fund, Edelweiss US Value Equity Off-shore and MSCI India Domestic & World Healthcare 45 Index Fund. However, existing SIPs and STPs will continue to be processed as per mandate. In October, 2025, the fund house already stopped lump sum investment in these funds and capped SIP and STP at ₹5,000 per PAN per month. **THRESHOLD HIT** Investors are requested to note that the AMC's available headroom for overseas investment, as per the MF level limit set on February, 2022, is now nearing its

threshold and hence it is decided to suspend the new subscription and fresh monthly Systematic Investment Plan and monthly Systematic Transfer Plan in seven overseas schemes from July 10, said the fund house. The existing systematic transactions, viz. SIPs/STPs etc., will remain unaffected, it added. Of the 66 international funds, about 54 have already stopped accepting fresh money. The industry hit its overseas investment ceiling in 2022. The RBI and SEBI has capped the industry foreign investment limit at \$7 billion with a separate \$1 billion limit for overseas ETFs.

Nifty, Sensex gain 1% each; Midcap index hits new high

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai



The markets closed the week on a firm note on Friday, with benchmark indices extending their recovery for a second straight session after last week's geopolitical-driven sell-off. The trigger was better-than-expected earnings from TCS, which gave the battered IT sector a credible floor, while strong quarterly numbers from public sector banks and persistent buying in realty stocks kept the broader momentum intact. The Nifty 50 gained 1.02 per cent to settle at 24,206, while the Sensex advanced 1.08 per cent to close at 77,569. However, both the indices closed the week in red, falling 0.3 per cent each. However, it was broader market that stole the show. The Nifty Midcap 100 rose 1.40 per cent to close at a fresh record high, while the Nifty Smallcap 100 gained 1.49 per cent, reflecting healthy participation across market capitalisation segments. The mid-cap and small-cap indices rose 1.36 per cent and 1.26 per cent respectively. Foreign portfolio investors continue their buying spree. On Friday, they bought shares worth ₹2,603 crore.

"TCS delivered last night and the numbers mattered. AI-led revenue crossed a \$2.6 billion annualised run rate. The order book came in at \$9.5 billion. For a sector that has been written off for weeks, that is a significant statement," said Sarvam Goel, Founder, Pocketful. **SECTOR RALLY** TCS posted revenue growth of 13.9 per cent in Q1 FY27, lifting the IT sector 2 per

cent on the day. PSU banks were another standout, with the Nifty PSU Bank index jumping 3 per cent. Bank of Maharashtra reported a 27 per cent year-on-year rise in net profit to ₹2,020 crore, while Indian Bank's net profit rose 10.1 per cent to ₹3,273 crore. Indian Bank also announced plans to raise up to \$1.5 billion through FCNR(B) deposits. Realty extended its out-performance, ending the week as the top sectoral gainer with a 5.29 per cent weekly advance. Media was the week's worst performer, shedding 2 per cent. "Markets witnessed a strong rebound on Friday. The positive undertone was primarily driven by a steady start to the Q1 earnings season, with TCS's in-line results relieving participants. Besides, continued softness in crude oil prices and stability in the rupee further supported investor confidence," said Ajit Mishra, SVP Research, Religare Broking. Emkay Global Research sees a little risk to the FY27E Nifty EPS growth forecast of 15 per cent, with demand remaining strong and some margin tailwinds kicking in from Q2-FY27E onwards. "The two-year time correction has taken Nifty PE to 18.9x, 3.5 per cent below 5Y LTA, and we remain constructive on Indian equities. We maintain our March-27 Nifty forecast at 29,000, implying a 1YF PE at 20.9x, close to LTA."

From Alps to Himalayas: Europe's IPO aspirants head to India

RINGSIDE VIEW.
KS BADRI NARAYANAN

The composition of India's primary market is likely to undergo a noticeable transformation as European companies set their sights on listing on domestic exchanges — BSE and the National Stock Exchange. More than half a dozen companies from the Alpine region and its neighbouring countries have either filed their draft papers with the market regulator Securities and Exchange Board of India or are expected to do so shortly. Among them is Bonfiglioli Transmissions Ltd, the Indian arm of Italy's Bonfiglioli Group. The electro-mechanical power transmission and industrial drive solutions company plans to launch a ₹2,000 crore IPO, for which it received SEBI's approval in June. The public issue will consist entirely of an offer for sale (OFS) of 4.7 crore shares by the promoter, Bonfiglioli S.p.A. Gaming software company PlaySimple, owned by Sweden-based Modern

Times Group, recently filed for a ₹3,150-crore IPO with SEBI. Similarly, Innothera Ltd, the Indian subsidiary of Switzerland-based Innothera AG, filed its draft papers in June for an IPO comprising a fresh issue of up to ₹105 crore and an OFS of up to 70.55 lakh equity shares. According to reports, Swedish private equity firm EQT Partners is planning a ₹3,800-crore IPO for its out-sourcing platform, Straive. Separately, another EQT-backed company, Virtusa, is also exploring India listing, reports suggest. Besides, Webasto, German automotive components maker, is also eyeing an IPO early next year, according to market buzz. European participation extends beyond fresh listings. In SBI Funds Management's ₹11,700-crore IPO, which opens on Tuesday, French asset manager Amundi — the largest investment manager in Europe — has been a long-standing partner. Even after selling about 7.54 crore shares through the OFS, Amundi will retain nearly a 33 per cent stake. A Cyprus-based non-bank financial company, Elli-



KEY CONCERN. A significant portion of the money raised by the European companies will flow to the coffers of the foreign promoters rather than fund the business

nas Finance, recently listed its shares on the NSE International Exchange (NSE IX) at GIFT City, becoming the first foreign company to achieve a cross-border equity listing in India. The proposed India-European Union Free Trade Agreement (FTA) is also expected to strengthen investor interest. European companies are beginning to view India as a more strategic market. Dubbed the "mother of all trade deals," the agreement is expected to eliminate tariffs on 90 per cent of India's exports (by value) from Day One, with tariff concessions eventually covering 99.5 per cent of exports over seven years. The deal is expected to be signed by the

end of this year or early next year. **JAPAN, KOREA FIRMS** Foreign companies tapping Indian markets is not new. In fact, last year Korean firms LG Electronics and Hyundai Motors India launched mega IPOs that received strong response from Indian investors. Samsung, another Korean multinational manufacturing conglomerate, plans to tap Indian markets. As many as two dozen Japanese companies are listed in India, including Maruti Suzuki, Kansai Paints, Honda India, SML Isuzu, Dai-ichi Karkaria and Sumitomo Chemicals. A recent report from Redseer said domestic mutual funds, insurers and

pension funds, supported by sustained SIP inflows, have steadily increased their participation in IPOs over the past five years, while foreign investors have continued to participate alongside them. "The balance of capital is now far more even, giving India's IPO market a stronger domestic foundation and reducing its dependence on external flows during periods of global volatility. That shift reflects a market that has become deeper, more self-sustaining and better equipped to support a long pipeline of listings." For domestic investors, this is a healthy trend as they will have more diversified set of companies from across the globe, especially at a time when overseas investments remain constrained under Liberalised Remittance Scheme. However, a key concern is that a significant portion of the funds raised through these IPOs will flow to the coffers of foreign promoters rather than fund business expansion. Even so, the direction of travel is unmistakable. India's primary market is evolving into a global capital-raising hub, attracting an increasing number of international companies and capital.

Kusumgar IPO subscribed 128.85x as QIBs pour in money

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The initial public offering of engineered fabric manufacturer Kusumgar received a whopping 128.85 times subscription on the closing day of bidding on Friday, driven by strong response from Qualified Institutional Buyers (QIBs). The ₹650-crore IPO attracted bids for about 147.76 crore shares against 1.15 crore shares on offer, according to NSE data. **INVESTOR INTEREST** The portion reserved for QIBs was subscribed a massive 284.10 times. The category for non-institutional investors was booked

165.46 times and the retail investors subscribed their quota 26.47 times. The IPO price band was fixed at ₹398 to ₹419 per share. Kusumgar IPO was fully subscribed on the first day of bidding on Thursday. The IPO is entirely an offer-for-sale (OFS). Since the issue is an OFS, the Mumbai-based firm will not receive any proceeds and the funds will go entirely to the selling shareholders. The firm has garnered ₹193.9 crore from anchor investors. Axis Capital, IIFL Capital Services, and Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors are the book-running lead managers to the IPO.

SEBI clears IPOs of Zetwerk, 3 others

Our Bureau/PTI
Bengaluru/New Delhi

Four companies — Zetwerk Manufacturing Business, Marri Retail, Tonbo Imaging India and Gujarat Victory Forgings — have secured SEBI's approval to raise funds through initial public offerings (IPOs), an update with the markets regulator showed on Friday. The IPO of Zetwerk, a B2B managed contract manufacturing platform, is likely to include a fresh issue and an offer for sale by existing shareholders. The company's existing investors include Khosla Ventures, Baillie Gifford, Rakesh Gangwal, Accel, Peak XV, GreenOak and Lightspeed. Its business spans sectors such as energy, electronics,

defence, aerospace, and capital goods, along with a platform focused on industrial supply and raw material procurement. Zetwerk is also in talks to raise a \$50-60 million pre-IPO funding with a \$3 billion valuation to improve its balance sheet and provide a partial exit to early investors. **MARRI RETAIL** Marri Retail's proposed IPO is a combination of a fresh issue worth ₹522 crore and an OFS of 2.7 crore shares by promoter Marri Venkat Reddy. The Hyderabad-based company plans to use proceeds from the fresh issuance for payment of debt, opening of 10 new apparel stores, one new apparel store with a jewellery Store-in-Store (Integrated Retail Store) and two

new standalone jewellery stores, expenses towards lease and sub-lease rent payments for existing stores and warehouses and general corporate purposes. Global defence electronics OEM Tonbo Imaging's issue will be entirely an OFS by its promoters and investors. Gujarat Victory Forgings' IPO comprises a fresh issue of up to 65 lakh equity shares and an offer for sale of up to 1.32 crore shares by a promoter, draft papers showed. The Vadodara-based company plans to utilise the proceeds from the fresh issue towards funding capital expenditure for expansion of its existing Unit III at Vadodara, including increasing manufacturing capacity of copper cathodes, payment of debt and for general corporate purposes.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 244.10 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Reliance Ind	1307.80	41.31	18.48	7.97	
ICICI Bank	1401.20	32.07	17.35	9.06	
HDFC Bank	524.95	24.75	16.04	11.40	
Axis Bank	1233.70	16.37	15.51	3.43	
L&T	3945.80	15.29	28.64	4.17	
Infosys	1068.00	13.18	14.70	3.38	
State Bank	1036.00	12.55	11.03	3.86	
Bajaj Finance	1020.50	9.78	32.87	2.47	
M&M	3129.40	8.58	20.90	2.52	
Bharti Elec	414.85	6.77	50.30	1.23	
FY Financial Services Ltd.	241.96	6.16	102.36	0.72	
Tata Steel	191.19	5.92	21.93	1.43	
UltraTech Cement	1171.00	4.83	42.15	1.25	
Adani Enter	3157.30	4.64	41.28	0.82	
Adani Ports	1828.10	4.51	32.95	1.22	
TCS	2069.00	4.35	15.14	1.91	
Int'l Globevni	5312.00	4.08	0.00	1.08	
SBI Life	1862.90	4.04	75.65	0.76	
JSW Steel	1245.40	4.02	11.94	1.05	
Tech Mahindra	1454.80	3.95	29.67	0.83	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1044.10	3.79	24.51	1.32	
HDFC Life	567.70	3.72	64.06	0.55	
Maruti Suzuki	13854.00	3.59	29.04	1.05	
HCL Tech	1164.10	3.15	18.97	1.11	
Tata Motors PV	337.95	2.94	4148.71	0.64	
Bajaj Finserv	1916.00	2.66	15.59	1.00	
Titan	4584.40	2.58	80.21	1.71	
Grassim Ind	3213.60	1.79	21.23	1.09	
PowerGrid Corp	283.10	1.73	16.53	1.16	
Wipro	1175.46	1.69	13.89	0.67	
Hindalco	967.45	1.26	16.24	1.26	
Hind Unilever	2156.00	1.18	47.75	1.72	
Max Healthcare	1108.10	1.11	74.77	0.74	
ONGC	244.96	1.11	6.19	0.86	
NTPC	344.55	0.88	12.13	1.47	
Tata Consumer Product	1111.90	0.71	71.14	1.25	
Kotak Bank	377.60	0.72	19.47	2.51	
Asian Paints	2677.80	0.40	58.45	1.09	
Eicher Motors	7365.50	0.14	36.66	0.92	
Bajaj Auto	10156.00	0.02	26.84	1.01	
Trent Ltd.	2902.80	-0.09	89.93	0.87	
Apollo Hosp	884.45	-0.17	33.73	2.48	
Cipla	1439.40	-0.23	30.11	0.82	
Coal India	429.30	-0.31	8.51	0.93	
ITC	281.75	-0.63	16.80	2.45	
Sun Pharma	1935.50	-0.74	40.35	1.85	
NestleIndia	1455.20	-1.25	80.19	0.94	
Dr Reddy's Lab	1242.30	-3.36	24.98	0.88	
Eternal Ltd.	389.65	-4.42	75.72	1.80	
Bharti Airtel	1920.40	-7.11	34.60	5.27	

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 905.95 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Hindustan aeronautics	4506.80	71.11	33.06	3.46	
Solar Industries	18236.00	61.11	95.02	1.80	
Indian Hotels Co. .	752.30	53.66	47.65	2.67	
Lindmedtree	4037.20	48.76	24.03	1.52	
DIF	685.75	49.16	38.45	1.78	
Adanienergyenergy	1536.60	49.13	127.38	2.09	
Union Bank	164.51	41.06	6.46	1.29	
Canara Bank	128.78	39.20	6.53	1.75	
Bank of Baroda	250.95	34.53	6.47	1.88	
Adani Energy Solutions .	1654.00	32.17	83.04	2.20	
Cummins India	5621.50	31.28	65.98	1.92	
Tata Power	381.30	28.35	23.81	2.57	
Gail (India)	173.73	27.91	15.07	1.90	
Adani Power .	218.45	25.90	32.48	3.67	
Hyundai Motor India .	1984.90	24.53	29.69	1.15	
Jindal Steel	1051.30	23.34	31.91	1.58	
Macrotech Developers .	1220.75	23.25	35.55	1.37	
Siemens Energy India .	3526.90	23.04	95.89	1.26	
Muthootfin	3129.40	22.63	11.84	1.36	
Cholamandalam&Fin	1807.80	20.16	29.45	3.17	
Punjab Natl Bank	105.41	19.88	6.56	1.47	
Tata Motors Cv	422.50	16.22	51.38	3.57	
Armbuja Cements	436.45	15.17	33.73	1.10	
Hdfc. amc	2761.20	14.40	41.41	2.28	
Shree Cement	26615.00	12.54	54.92	1.44	
Hindus Zinc	536.95	11.91	16.40	1.05	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	916.60	11.45	120.63	2.54	
Mazagon Dock	2420.10	10.53	35.43	0.74	
Indian Railway Finance Corp.	89.90	10.49	16.76	0.73	
Power Finance	406.50	10.24	3.99	2.40	
Bajaj Holdings	10654.00	9.26	12.11	1.87	
Bpcl	309.75	9.21	5.20	2.54	
Divis Lab	6836.00	8.57	70.67	3.52	
Indian Oilcorp	138.96	7.67	4.49	2.10	
Pilidint	1598.50	7.36	65.85	2.01	
Tata Capital	360.50	7.01	31.30	0.73	
Vedanta	272.55	5.96	6.72	1.87	
Siemens	3496.50	5.21	81.24	1.25	
Samvardhamothersinternatl	143.19	5.05	36.99	2.56	
United Spirits .	1385.70	3.90	53.98	1.66	
Abb India	6836.00	2.46	91.68	1.45	
Godrej Consumer	1088.40	1.18	59.83	1.77	
Torrent Pharma	4901.50	1.01	77.59	2.08	
Avenuesuper	4081.10	0.80	89.63	2.66	
Rural Elec	351.95	-0.18	5.68	1.78	
Tvs Motor Comp .	3623.10	-2.07	54.02	2.45	
Britannia Ind	5353.00	-2.93	50.82	2.55	
Zydusfisciences	11580.00	-6.01	22.60	1.17	
Bosch	41815.00	-10.42	44.47	1.47	
Venar Beverages .	478.10	-13.22	50.39	2.65	

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Gold eases as West Asian tensions lift rate hike bets



Gold eased on Friday and was on course for a weekly decline, as higher oil prices linked to the Middle East conflict fuelled inflation concerns and bolstered expectations of tighter US monetary policy. Spot gold slid 0.5 per cent to \$4,101.70 per ounce by 1311 GMT. US gold futures for August delivery dropped 0.7 per cent to \$4,110.60. Silver fell 0.4 per cent to \$59.7338 per ounce. REUTERS

Aluminium falls on EGA alumina restart

Aluminium prices fell sharply as Emirates Global Aluminium (EGA) said it had restarted its alumina refinery in the UAE after a 3-1/2-month outage. Benchmark three-month aluminium on the LME was down 1.5 per cent at \$3,152.50 a tonne. Copper slipped 0.3 per cent to \$13,453. REUTERS

Palm oil slips over 1% on bearish MPOB data



Kuala Lumpur: Malaysian palm oil futures tumbled more than 1 per cent as industry data showed that stocks climbed to a four-month high in June. The benchmark palm oil contract for September delivery on the BMD Exchange was down 83 ringgit at 4,511 ringgit (\$1,109.17) a tonne. REUTERS

‘India should opt for need-based grain procurement’

TIME TO RESET. Ramesh Chand calls for alternative procurement policy and MSP via price differential payment

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Varanasi

The government should opt for need-based procurement of wheat and rice, but ensure minimum support price (MSP) for farmers through price differential payment (DP), former NITI Aayog member Ramesh Chand has said.

“The government should come up with an alternative procurement policy by allowing the private sector to buy more grain, but at the same time ensure MSP to farmers through DP,” he said in his address at the Wheat Products Promotion Society (WPPS) CEO’s conclave ‘Re-defining Wheat Value Chains

for a New India’.

Procurement of wheat and rice should be limited to meeting the demand for the public distribution system (PDS) and welfare schemes run by the government, he said.

VALUE ADDITION HIT

Stating that value-addition helps in the country’s economic growth, he said the procurement of foodgrains under MSP was affecting value-addition.

“The private sector is the biggest contributor to value-addition and economic growth,” the former NITI Aayog member said.

Stating that a State like Uttar Pradesh was doing a higher value addition to

Procurement of wheat and rice should be limited to meeting demand for the PDS and welfare schemes run by the government

RAMESH CHAND
Former NITI Aayog member



DBT PAYMENT

DP payment can be made through direct benefit transfer (DBT), which is picking up. “Despite procurement of wheat and rice by the government, malnutrition in the country is above 10 per cent,” said Chand, who is also an agricultural econom-

ist. “The agriculture sector has grown 10 per cent in the past few years despite facing such challenges,” he said.

MSP procurement does not encourage higher production growth, as seen in the case of rice and wheat. “They have witnessed only 2.5 per cent growth in recent years. Production of horticultural crops has increased by 3.5 per cent, that of dairy by 4.5 per cent, and corn has witnessed 9 per cent growth,” said Chand.

AGRI EXPORT COMPLEX

Manoj Kumar Singh, CEO, UP State Transformation Commission, in his address, said an agriculture commodity export complex was coming up near the Jewar airport

in Noida on 50 acres.

“The complex will have testing and treatment facilities for all commodities so that farmers can get more value for their products through exports,” he said.

Calling for more value addition to cereals to ensure better returns to farmers, Singh said Uttar Pradesh would increase wheat processing to 60 per cent, raising its value to ₹40,000-70,000 crore from the current ₹30,000 crore. “It will create 2.5 lakh additional employment,” he said.

MANDI FEE EXEMPTION

In his welcome address, Deepak Kumar Bajaj, President of the UP Roller Flour Millers Association (UP-

RFMA), sought exemption from *mandi* fees for wheat procurement by the industry. It was costing the government an additional ₹350 a quintal in procurement.

Ajay Goyal, WPPS President, said artificial intelligence is changing the rules of the game, and the industry should adapt to the changes brought in by it.

The two-day conclave, hosted by WPPS along with UPRFMA, discussed various issues such as climate, price risk, policy, procurement, trade, storage supply chain, food security and milling technologies.

The writer was in Varanasi at the invitation of WPPS

W. Asia tensions dampen export purchase of tea at Kochi auctions

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

The continuing uncertainty over the conflict in West Asia is prompting tea exporters to adopt a cautious procurement strategy, resulting in subdued buying at the Kochi tea auctions.

According to Anil George Joseph, President of the Tea Trade Association of Cochin, export-oriented orthodox teas continue to face headwinds due to weaker demand from key West Asian markets, higher freight and insurance costs, and payment uncertainties stemming from the geopolitical situation.

“These factors have made exporters cautious in their procurement, even as steady domestic demand continues to support prices of quality CTC teas,” he said.

A tea exporter participat-

ing in the auctions said fresh export commitments had become increasingly difficult, with freight charges having doubled and severe port congestion disrupting shipments.

FREIGHT CHARGES

Cecil Jose of Festival Global Beverages said overseas buyers were cancelling orders because of uncertainty over shipping schedules, soaring freight rates and a build-up of containers at ports. The latest developments in West Asia have further aggravated delays and congestion, while shipping lines are raising freight charges almost daily, he said. Jose urged the Centre to intervene to facilitate timely cargo movement and ensure smoother export shipments.

Auctioneers Forbes, Ewart & Figgis said the average price realisation for ortho-

dox teas fell ₹4 to ₹186 a kg in sale 28. Of the 3,03,596 kg offered, 85 per cent was sold. The market for whole-leaf teas was barely steady to selectively dearer depending on quality, while broken teas weakened and witnessed some withdrawals.

However, quality CTC teas continued to command a premium, supported by steady domestic consumption and institutional demand. High-priced and popular Kerala marks were firm to ₹2-₹3 dearer. Of the 7,11,095 kg of CTC dust offered, 87 per cent was sold, with blenders accounting for 69 per cent of the total quantity purchased.

Orthodox dust also witnessed healthy demand, with 93 per cent of the 7,828 kg offered being sold. Upcountry buyers and exporters accounted for a small share of purchases.

NOAA sees 81% chance of a very strong El Nino by the year-end

Srikrishnan PC
Chennai

The latest report from the US National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration’s (NOAA) Climate Prediction Center (CPC) indicates that El Nino is strengthening and is likely to persist through the rest of 2026.

There is an 81 per cent probability of a very strong El Nino emerging during October-December, potentially ranking among the strongest events on record since 1950.

The CPC also estimates a 97 per cent chance that El Nino will persist into early spring 2027.

WARMING SIGNALS

According to the report, El Nino strengthened over the past month, with sea surface temperature anomalies ex-

ceeding +1°C across much of the central and eastern equatorial Pacific.

The latest weekly Nino-3.4 index stood at +1.2°C, while the Nino-4 and Nino-1+2 indices were +0.5°C and +2.7°C, respectively.

OCEAN PULSE

The equatorial subsurface temperature index (averaged between 180° and 100°W) increased as a downwelling Kelvin wave deepened the thermocline and warmed the eastern Pacific. A downwelling Kelvin wave — an eastward-moving pulse of warm subsurface water triggered by weakening trade winds or westerly wind bursts — helps reinforce El Nino by deepening the thermocline, the boundary between warm surface waters and cooler deep

With a 97% probability, El Nino is expected to remain active through early 2027, says the US weather body

ocean-atmosphere system continues to reflect a strengthening El Nino.

OUTLOOK

The North American Multi-Model Ensemble (NMME) forecast suggests that El Nino will continue to intensify through 2026.

Model guidance and the strong coupling between the Pacific Ocean and the atmosphere have increased confidence that the event will persist into early 2027.

Ocean-atmosphere coupling refers to the interaction between sea surface temperatures and atmospheric circulation.

Changes in ocean temperatures influence winds and rainfall patterns, while the atmosphere, in turn, affects ocean conditions, shaping weather patterns across the globe.

Agro-chemicals start-up Atomgrid to launch product for Indian farmers soon

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Speciality chemicals R&D start-up AtomGrid, which custom manufactures and sources for specialty agri chemicals, plans to launch products for farmers over the next 3-4 months.

“We will launch our end customer brand in India in the next 3-4 months. There are limited brands from India which go to the end farmer globally. So that is the opportunity we are chasing,” said the Bengaluru-based company’s Co-founder Siddharth Gupta.

Launched in January 2023, Atomgrid helps Indian companies capture value in the downstream value chain. In the B2B segment, it sells under the Atomgrid label, supplying finished goods and



Atomgrid Co-founder Siddharth Gupta

raw materials to the end customer.

EXPORT REVENUE

The start-up has manufacturing units in Gujarat and Maharashtra. Nearly 50 per cent of its revenue comes from Vietnam, Latin America, and Africa. It plans to enter the US in 2-3 years. “The initial target for us is Africa, Latin America and South-East Asia, after which we’ll look at the US and

Europe,” said Gupta.

The company is working on pesticides, while biologicals are in the pipeline. It is working with 10-15 manufacturers in India on the active ingredients side, and a similar number on the formulations side.

While most of the business happens in the business-to-business (B2B) segment, Atomgrid plans to enter the business-to-consumer (B2C) segment too. “We are building a company whose brands will go to end farmers globally,” he said in an online interview with *businessline*.

In the B2B segment, the customers it works for, especially in developed countries, are looking to diversify; they don’t want to depend totally on a Chinese supplier. It is building its own agrochemicals company, which works

with manufacturing units.

The company is registering its products globally and launching its brands. “We work with manufacturers in India, take our product registrations globally and export the products,” said Gupta.

CHINA +1 OPTION

He said the company was targeting 3X growth this fiscal by entering more geographies. With the firm establishing its R&D centre, it will double the number of products it manufactures. It will invest in joint ventures on the manufacturing side to strengthen supplies.

The idea behind AtomGrid is to capture the China-plus-one opportunity coming to the Indian manufacturing sector. Atomgrid has 40-50 products, comprising herbicides, fungicides and pesticides.

Crude oil eyes weekly gains as supply risks persist

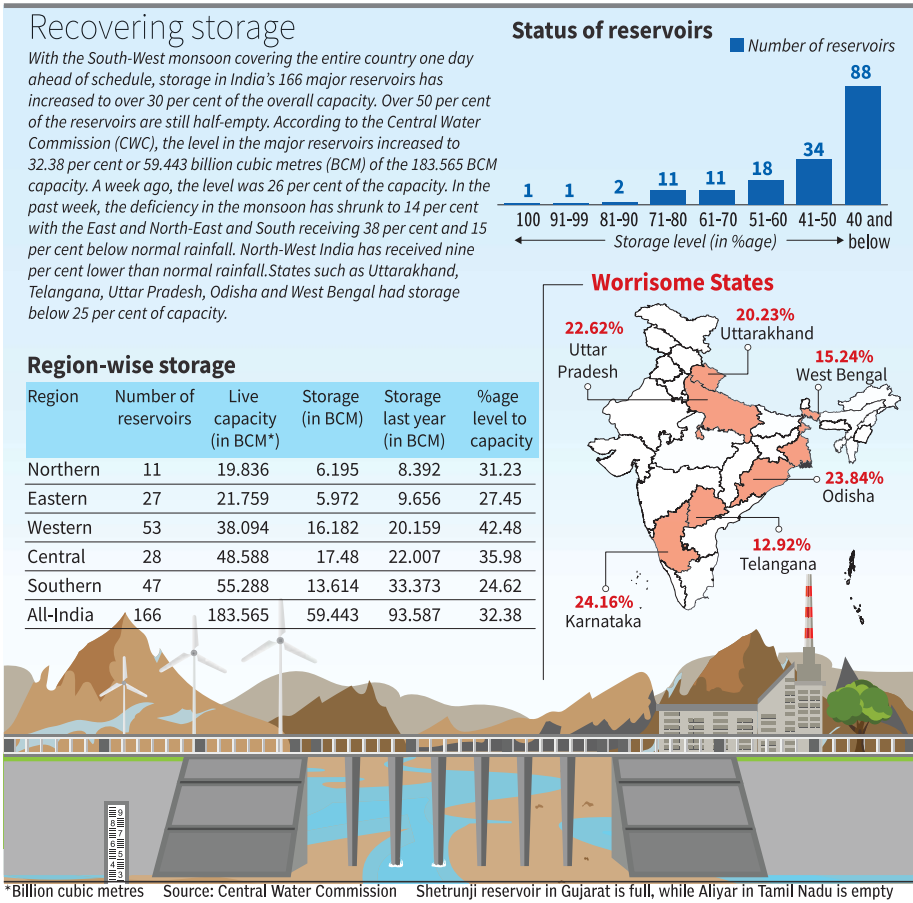
Reuters
London

Crude oil prices rose on Friday and were on track for weekly gains as renewed US-Iran fighting disrupted shipping in the Strait of Hormuz, stoking concerns over supply disruptions.

Brent futures were up 24 cents at \$76.54 a barrel by 1224 GMT. US WTI crude rose 9 cents to \$72.17.

For the week, Brent was set for a gain of about six per cent and WTI was on track for an increase of about five per cent.

The recent escalation in hostilities between the US and Iran could upend the International Energy Agency’s forecast of a significant oil market surplus next year, it said on Friday.



Nabard helps in GI registration of 28 products from Bihar, Assam

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

The National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (Nabard) said on Friday that it has facilitated the Geographical Indication registration of 28 products such as traditional handicrafts, handloom textiles and bamboo crafts, among others, across the country. Till date, Nabard has supported 176 products in securing GI registration.

The latest additions span a diverse range of traditional handicrafts, handloom textiles, bamboo crafts, metal-work, pottery, paintings and musical instruments, further strengthening India’s portfolio of region-specific products with legal protection and global market potential, the bank said in a statement.

Among the newly registered products are Nalanda Bawanbuti saree and fabrics and Gaya Pattharkatti stone craft from Bihar; Kuchai silk saree and fabrics from Jharkhand; Ba Shilp (bamboo craft) and Bihu Pepa from Assam; Himachal wood carving craft; and Khajuraho metal craft from Madhya Pradesh, along with several other traditional products from across the country.

VALUE CHAINS

Shaji Krishnan V, Chairman, Nabard, said, “Geographical Indication registration is a powerful instrument for protecting traditional knowledge, promoting local entrepreneurship, and creating value for rural producers. Nabard remains committed to strengthening GI-based value chains through producer collectivisation, skill de-

velopment, enterprise promotion, branding, market linkages, and export facilitation, ensuring that India’s unique heritage translates into lasting economic opportunities.”

Nabard’s GI-led interventions have helped connect more than 13,000 artisans and producers to higher-value domestic markets, strengthening rural livelihoods and enhancing the commercial potential of traditional products.

Through Nabard-supported GI value chains and associated enterprises, the initiative has generated more than 50,000 direct jobs.

A total of 14 rural enterprise producer organisations (REPOs) are engaged in the production and promotion of various GI products across Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Jammu & Kashmir, Karnataka, and Gujarat.

India’s food waste is also a climate issue, says WRI India

Solid food waste emitted 106.62 mt of carbon dioxide equivalent in 2023, per a technical note

AJ Vinayak
Mangaluru

Food waste is a significant contributor to greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions in India and deserves greater attention in climate policy, according to a technical note by WRI India, an independent knowledge organisation registered as India Resources Trust.

The note, *India Food Waste GHG Emission Estimation Tool*, authored by Shwetmala Kashyap, Ritoja Basu and Shweta Lamba, warned that food waste-related emissions will rise as the population grows and consumption patterns evolve unless corrective measures are taken.

It estimates that solid food waste generated 106.62 million tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent



GROWING PILE. India produced 62 mt of municipal solid waste in 2022-23, a figure projected to rise to 165 mt by 2030

(CO₂e) emissions in 2023. India produced 62 million tonnes (mt) of municipal solid waste (MSW) in 2022-23, a figure projected to increase to 165 mt by 2030 and 436 mt by 2050.

The note said that existing municipal, national and climate policy frameworks do not adequately address food waste, arguing that it is not merely a resource-loss issue but a climate challenge one.

Tackling food waste emissions, it said, is essential for equitable and climate-resilient urban development.

Globally, about 60 per cent of food waste originates from households, 28 per cent from food service providers and 12 per cent from the retail sector.

Across the food supply chain — from production and consumption to disposal — 1,052 million

tonnes of food waste were generated worldwide in 2022, representing nearly 19 per cent of the food available to consumers.

CLIMATE ACTION

The report called for a decentralised, India-specific tool that can capture emissions across the food waste value chain, adapt to diverse local conditions, support data collection and help identify interventions.

WRI India’s *India Food Waste GHG Emission Estimation Tool* seeks to fill that gap by estimating emissions from food waste collection, transportation, treatment and disposal, while also quantifying avoided emissions from waste reduction strategies, particularly those focused on preventing food waste at source.

The tool enables city authorities, bulk waste generators and planning agencies to estimate and visualise food waste emissions, helping them measure climate impacts and align with sustainability and environmental, social and governance goals.

Designed to be transparent, scalable and adaptable across urban contexts, the tool can support state climate action plans, city climate roadmaps, circular economy initiatives and emissions inventories.

The note described the tool as a foundation for improving food waste data, decision-making and accountability, adding that it could evolve into a more robust decision-support system as more granular data and localised emission factors become available.

QUICKLY.

Advait Energy bags ₹251cr deal from Paschim Gujarat

New Delhi: Advait Energy Transitions on Friday said the company has secured orders worth over ₹251 crore in the domestic market. The four projects secured from Paschim Gujarat VU Co Ltd will be completed within 18 months, the company said in a regulatory filing. The orders include the conversion of 11 kV HT and LT line network into an underground cable network at various locations in Gujarat, the company informed the stock exchanges. **■**

Railways clears ₹206 crore Kavach Version 4.0 plan

New Delhi: The Railways have approved the installation of the automatic train protection system, Kavach Version 4.0, on 680 route kilometres of the Rewari-Delhi and Shakurbasti-Bathinda sections, including feeder branch lines, in the Delhi Division of Northern Railway. “The project has been approved at a cost of ₹206 crore,” a Railway Board statement said. It added, “The project forms part of Indian Railways’ ongoing nationwide rollout of Kavach, aimed at expanding the indigenous safety system across high-density and strategically important routes.” Kavach is India’s indigenously developed automatic train protection system, designed to significantly enhance railway safety by preventing signal passed at danger incidents. **■**

Mumbai Metro One signs agreement with NARCL to restructure its debt

Our Bureau

Mumbai

Mumbai Metro One Pvt Ltd (MMOPL) has entered into a debt restructuring agreement with the National Asset Reconstruction Co Ltd that will see its debt reduced by more than ₹1,100 crore, and the insolvency proceedings withdrawn. MMOPL, which owns, operates and maintains the heartline of Mumbai’s East-West connectivity Versova-Andheri-Ghatkopar Metro Line-1, is a 74:26 joint venture between Reliance Infrastructure Ltd and the Mumbai Metropolitan Region Development Authority (MMRDA). The line, which has a length of 11.4 km, has ridership of over 5 lakh commuters every day.

3 States account for 66% solar power additions in Q1: MNRE

SHINING BRIGHT. Gujarat, Rajasthan, UP added 7.8 GW of the total 11.9 GW installed

Rohan Das

Chennai

Despite record additions in capacity, India’s solar momentum continues to be largely driven by a handful of States.

According to Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) data, Gujarat, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh accounted for 7.8 GW of solar capacity added in the first quarter of FY27, about 66 per cent of the 11.9 GW added across the country.

As of June 2026, these States, alongside Maharashtra, have a combined installed capacity of over 100 GW, far eclipsing the 62 GW among all the other States.

Within solar, while Gujarat and Rajasthan lead in utility scale projects, Uttar Pradesh is the clear winner in terms of rooftop solar, with the State adding 1.6 GW in the June quarter.

Others like Kerala (187 MW), Odisha (161 MW), Madhya Pradesh (141 MW) and Tamil Nadu (104 MW) also showed encouraging additions in rooftop solar.

P Sivakumar, President of the Tamil Nadu Solar Energy Developers Association (TNSEDA), said that the increased adoption in the Western States is a combination of both strong struc-



Installed solar capacity additions in Q1FY27

State	Capacity added in Q1 (GW)
Gujarat	3.9
Rajasthan	2.3
Uttar Pradesh	1.6
Maharashtra	0.7
Andhra Pradesh	0.6
Total India	11.8

tural advantages and better policy frameworks.

He said Gujarat and Rajasthan possess some of the country’s highest solar irradiation levels and availability for utility-scale projects.

“Moreover, they have moved early by coming up with the right policies to encourage growth, making project execution faster,” he said.

SOME CHALLENGES

The free electricity schemes in many States have reduced

Despite large additions, these States have nevertheless faced challenges with grid infrastructure and curtailment

the need for rooftop solar in most households, Sivakumar added.

Despite large additions, these States have nevertheless faced challenges with grid infrastructure and curtailment.

At a recent renewable energy conclave, Ravichandran Puroshothaman, Chairman of the CII Southern Region, said that in March 2026 alone 8 GW of solar capacity in Rajasthan had to be forcibly curtailed because the grid could not absorb the electricity being generated.

“The losses were significant. For instance, a 250 MW solar plant lost around ₹51 lakh in a fortnight despite operating normally. The problem is that while solar parks are being developed rapidly, the transmission infrastructure, energy storage and demand-side flexibility has failed to keep pace,” he said. He added that Rajasthan’s experience should serve as a warning for every State that is aggressively expanding renewable capacity without simultaneously building the infrastructure and flexibility needed to utilise the power effectively.

Overall, India added 13.3 GW of renewable energy (excluding large hydro) in the June quarter as against 12.3 GW in the same quarter in the last financial year. Solar accounted for 11.9 GW while wind energy sector added 1.3 GW and large hydro additions stood at 600 MW.

“The losses were significant. For instance, a 250 MW solar plant lost around ₹51 lakh in a fortnight despite operating normally. The problem is that while solar parks are being developed rapidly, the transmission infrastructure, energy storage and demand-side flexibility has failed to keep pace,” he said. He added that Rajasthan’s experience should serve as a warning for every State that is aggressively expanding renewable capacity without simultaneously building the infrastructure and flexibility needed to utilise the power effectively.

In first visit to Karur post stampede, Vijay ups attack on DMK, offers jobs to victims’ families

Our Bureau

Chennai

Ten months after the stampede that claimed 41 lives on September 27 last year during a political rally he addressed before the Tamil Nadu Assembly elections, Chief Minister Joseph Vijay returned to Karur on Friday and stepped up the attack on opposition parties.

The TVK president did not pull any punches on Friday, and kicked off his address emphasising the deep scar that the incident had left on him.

He claimed that he was misled by police officers acting under the orders of others. “I live with the pain of losing my brothers and sisters and you continue to blame me, saying that I went into hiding. I am asking you, did the police provide appropriate security in Karur that



COUNTERMOVE. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay addressing a public meeting in Karur on Friday **VENGADESH R**

day?” he said. Vijay also announced plans to set up a memorial in Karur, and handed over government job orders to the victims’ family members.

He slammed the corrupt governance of the previous DMK government, describing it as an “evil force”.

‘SAY NO TO BRIBE’

“In every department, they keep saying money is being looted in the name of ‘party fund.’ The funniest part is that in the Assembly, I merely said party fund. I didn’t mention which party, whose fund or anybody’s name. But the moment I said

CISF recovers 428 tonnes of coal in Jharkhand, West Bengal crackdown

Our Bureau

New Delhi

The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) launched a four-day crackdown and recovered 428.34 tonnes of illegally mined, stored or transported coal in Jharkhand and West Bengal.

The CISF’s operational authority has expanded under Sections 22, 23B and 24 of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, empowering the force to launch intelligence-driven operations in coordination with Coal India subsidiaries, the local police and the district administration for safeguarding national mineral resources and strengthen transparency in the coal sector. It is also aimed at intensifying the Centre’s “zero coal leakage” initiative.

JOINT OPERATIONS

From July 4 to July 8, the CISF said it carried out coordinated operations across coalfields of Bharat Coking Coal Ltd (BCCL), Eastern Coalfields Ltd (ECL) and Central Coalfields Ltd (CCL) in Jharkhand and West Bengal.

“The operations resulted in the recovery of 428.34 tonnes of illegally mined, stored or transported coal, registration of four FIRs, seizure of one Hyva truck and more than 13 motorcycles and other equipment



SAFEGUARDING RESOURCES. The CISF targeted vulnerable mining belts and coal transportation corridors in its enforcement drive, aided by technology like drones

used in illegal mining and transportation, besides apprehension of offenders and initiation of legal proceedings under the MMDR Act,” said the CISF in a statement.

The force targeted several vulnerable mining belts and coal transportation corridors in its enforcement drive, which was aided by use of technology like drones.

At BCCL, Dhanbad, the CISF carried out intelligence-based raids in Katras, Block-II, Basantimata (Kargil), Kustore, Sijua, Jealgora, Barora, Govindpur and NTST areas. Acting on specific intelligence inputs, drone surveillance and field verification, the CISF recovered 319.54 tonnes of illegally stored coal, seized a coal-laden truck and multiple motorcycles used for illegal transportation, and initiated legal action under the MMDR Act.

At ECL Sheetalpur, the force said, operations were conducted in Rajmahal, Salanpur, Chitra, Chapapur-II OCP (Mugma Area), Sonepur-Bazari and Kunustoria areas.

The CISF also undertook inspections of coal depots, weighbridges, transportation documents and statutory production and dispatch records. These actions resulted in the recovery of 85.93 tonnes of illegally mined and stocked coal, seizure of vehicles used in illegal transportation and apprehension of trespassers.

Preventive inspections also confirmed compliance at several operational locations, reinforcing transparency and accountability in coal movement.

It also covered CCL Piparwar and Kargali, recovering 13.62 tonnes and 9.25 tonnes of illegally extracted coal.

Naveen Jindal to invest ₹70,000 cr in Jharkhand

Press Trust of India

New Delhi

Industrialist Naveen Jindal announced plans to invest over ₹70,000 crore to set up steel, nuclear energy and renewable energy projects in Jharkhand. His group signed an agreement in this regard with the Government of Jharkhand, Jindal said in a video message.

“I am pleased to announce that the Naveen Jindal Group proposes to invest more than ₹70,000 crore across steel, nuclear energy and renewable energy projects in the State,” he said.

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

The proposed investment includes ₹40,000 crore in steel, strengthening Jharkhand’s manufacturing ecosystem and creating around 10,000 direct employment opportunities, besides generating

significant opportunities for MSMEs, downstream industries and local entrepreneurs.

NUCLEAR ENERGY

The group also proposes to invest ₹30,000 crore in nuclear energy. Reliable and affordable power is essential for sustained industrial growth. Nuclear energy will provide clean, dependable, round-the-clock power, create highly skilled employment and support the growth of future industries, including data centres and advanced manufacturing, Jindal said.

“In addition, we propose to invest ₹650 crore in solar energy, supporting Jharkhand’s clean energy ambitions,” he stated.

About the agreement with the Jharkhand government, the industrialist said the State had a strong industrial foundation.

Madras HC restrains poll panel from notifying bypolls to 5 seats in TN

Mohamed Imranullah S

Chennai

The Madras High Court on Friday restrained the Election Commission of India (ECI) from notifying byelections to the Tiruchi East, Perundurai, Ambasamudram, Virallimalai and Karur Assembly constituencies until July 31.

Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G Arul Murugan passed the interim order following a public interest litigation (PIL) petition filed by K Venkatachalapathy of Tirunelveli.

‘CLEAR VACANCY’

In his affidavit, the PIL petitioner contended that the ECI could not treat the vacancies that had arisen due to the five resignations as a ‘clear vacancy’ under Section 151A of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, since such vacancies would be subject to the result of the election petitions. Their election itself is under challenge in the court.

The interim orders were passed after hearing the preliminary submissions made by senior counsel G Masilamani for Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay, Advocate General Vijay Narayan for the Le-



gislative Assembly Secretary, Advocate VR Shanmugathan for the PIL petitioner and ECI counsel Niranjan Rajagopalan.

The judges granted the respondents time till July 31 for filing their counter affidavits to the main case.

TIMING OF EVENTS

The Advocate General said that there must be a distinction between those who had resigned prior to the filing of the election petitions and those after.

He said the Chief Minister had resigned from the Tiruchi (East) Assembly seat on May 10 itself but his rival candidate S Inigo Irudayaraj filed the election petition much later.

Pointing out that a few others, too, had resigned much before the filing of the election petitions challenging their victory, Narayan sought time to file a detailed

counter affidavit to the PIL plea. On his part, Masilamani, representing Vijay, questioned the *locus standi* of the PIL petitioner to dictate what the ECI must or must not do.

The senior counsel said the PIL petition was premature since the ECI had not taken any decision so far on the issue of conducting byelections to the five constituencies in question, and no notification to that effect had been issued.

ECI counsel Rajagopalan told the Bench that the commission had no clue about the prayers sought in the five election petitions since it was yet to receive court notices and be served with the papers.

MINISTERIAL DEFECTS

He wondered how the PIL petitioner gained access to the details of the five election petitions when they had been numbered by the High Court Registry subject to maintainability, and the petitions were yet to cure ministerial defects.

The Chief Justice’s Bench said that the A-G’s nuanced arguments concerning the date on which the vacancy had arisen compared to the dates on which the election petitions had been filed required deeper examination.

ED unearths undisclosed foreign assets, deals linked to Mumbai film producer, firm

Our Bureau

New Delhi

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has carried out searches on the premises of Mumbai-based film producer, Dharmesh Narendra Sangani, a business associate of veteran actor Shekhar Suman, and his company Kalanee Impex Pvt Ltd. The probe allegedly unravelled multiple undisclosed foreign assets and offshore bank accounts in the US, Canada and the UAE, and unrealised foreign remittances.

Shekhar Suman Film Academy (SSFA) is co-founded by Sangani and promoted by Suman. However, Kalanee Impex Pvt Ltd is a global trading firm, managing international trade transactions and commodity logistics.

Sangani is not new to controversy. In September 2016, UK Border Force officers seized approximately 7.4 kg of undeclared gold jewellery that Sangani allegedly tried to smuggle into the UK.

“Customs authorities of the USA and the UK are investigating certain transactions of Dharmesh Sangani, and ED is also investigating FEMA violations in such



transactions,” stated agency officials.

Sangani, alleged agency officials, threw his mobile phone from the 13th floor of a building in Mumbai during the search.

It was later retrieved and the sleuths are trying to extract information from the handset with the help of cyber and forensic experts.

DESTROYING EVIDENCE

In parallel, the ED has filed a complaint with the Mumbai Police, accusing the film producer of destroying evidence. Pointing at an anomaly detected, officials charged that the company did not realise export proceeds from certain overseas buyers within legally allowed time neither did it obtain extension of time from the authorised dealer bank. “There were no documented recovery efforts,” officials said.

Steady internet during security ops provides relief to J&K businesses

Gulzar Bhat

Srinagar

For the past seven days, security forces have been conducting an anti-militancy operation in the dense orchards of Shopian’s Meemander and Chanpora villages, about 53 km south of Srinagar.

A top Lashkar-e-Taiba commander was killed during the operation, and his bullet-riddled body was recovered on July 9.

Security forces continue to search for another militant believed to be hiding in the area.

For residents, traders and online businesses, uninterrupted connectivity has meant that life and work have continued with little disruption even as the security operation entered its second week.

BROADER SHIFT

“E-commerce and other internet-based businesses have been functioning without any disruption in the area,” said Suhail Ahmad, an e-commerce trader.

“The uninterrupted internet during an ongoing anti-militancy operation reflects a significant shift in security management. Authorities now appear to be balancing operational requirements

“In many ways, uninterrupted connectivity has become an indicator of the return to normalcy”

with the need to minimise disruptions to economic activity and everyday life,” said Shah Nawaz Hussain, a Valley-based political and security analyst.

“In many ways, uninterrupted connectivity has become an indicator of the return to normalcy,” he added.

Data from the Internet Shutdowns Tracker, maintained by the Software Freedom Law Center, India (SFLC.in), shows a sharp decline in internet shutdowns in Jammu and Kashmir over the past few years.

The region recorded three internet outages in the first six months of 2026, compared with 11 in 2025.

The number had already fallen to two in 2024 from 14 in 2023 and 43 in 2022. Internet services were suspended 79 times in 2021 and 116 times in 2020.

According to the 2024 research paper, *Impact on Economy Due to Internet Shutdown: A Case Study of*

Kashmir, each full day of internet suspension results in an estimated economic loss of ₹165 crore, with the tourism sector and small and medium enterprises (SMEs) suffering the largest proportional declines.

COMMERCIAL ACTIVITY

Qazi Tauseef, spokesperson for the Kashmir Economic Alliance (KEA), an umbrella organisation representing traders, transporters and other business bodies, said uninterrupted internet services had significantly benefited businesses across sectors.

“Keeping the internet operational has allowed trade to continue without disruption,” he added.

TO ADVERTISE PLEASE CONTACT

Chennai	: 044 - 28576300
Coimbatore	: 0422 - 2212572
Madurai	: 0452 - 2528497
Trichy	: 0431 - 2302801
Puducherry	: 0413 - 2224111

thehindu **businessline.**

QUICKLY.

DGCA warns IndiGo over cargo spillage

New Delhi: The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has issued a warning letter to IndiGo for spillage of cargo, the airline informed the stock exchange in a regulatory filing on Friday. The airline said there is no significant impact on the financials, operations or other activities of the company as a result of the warning letter, the airline said. IndiGo said the letter relates to spillage of cargo that was detected on the ground post the arrival of a flight and subsequent audit findings regarding deviations from standard operating procedures. **OUR BUREAU**

FDA approves Sanofi's anti-cancer treatment

The US Food and Drug Administration (FDA) said on Friday that it has approved a wearable form of Sanofi's blood cancer drug, Sarclisa, offering multiple myeloma patients a less burdensome alternative to intravenous infusions. It is the first cancer drug approved by the FDA that can be delivered through an on-body injector, attached to the skin. **REUTERS**

Mid-year e-commerce sales mixed, demand for premium buys resilient

SEASONAL TREND. Consumers willing to spend on big-ticket purchases but cautious on discretionary spending

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

E-commerce players have kicked off the mid-year on-line shopping season with mixed results across categories, underscoring resilient demand for premium products even as consumers remain cautious on overall spending ahead of the festive season.

While smartphones, electronics and home appliances continued to account for the bulk of sales value, average order values (AOVs) remained subdued as shoppers sought discounts and promotional offers, according to industry analysts.

“The value growth, a significant chunk of value growth comes from your smartphone category because the average selling price is on the higher side. But volume-wise, other categories are also doing well,” said Sathish Meena, Founder of Datum Intelligence. He added,



MARKET PULSE. The mid-year sales are increasingly becoming an important marker for consumer demand

“AOVs remain muted because everyone is looking for better deals and brands are also giving discounts.”

FESTIVE SEASON

According to Meena, the mid-year sales are increasingly becoming an important marker for consumer demand, although they still trail the festive season in scale. “The festive one is the

biggest one. Apart from the Big Billion Days and the Great Indian Festival, this is the other named sales event that customers look forward to,” he said, noting that shoppers now increasingly recognise these events as opportunities to purchase newly-launched products at attractive prices.

Amazon, which concluded its 10th Prime Day sale

earlier this week, said the event was its fastest ever.

In cities where Amazon Now is available, one in every two deal items was delivered within minutes, while same-day deliveries rose more than threefold compared with last year's Prime Day.

More than 70 per cent of new Prime memberships came from tier-II and tier-III cities, highlighting continued demand beyond metropolitan markets.

KEY TREND

The company also said premiumisation remained a key trend during the sale.

Premium beauty products grew three times year-on-year, premium televisions doubled, premium travel luggage rose 1.5 times, while AI-enabled PCs accounted for one in five Windows laptops sold during the event. Nearly half of Amazon Now orders comprised non-grocery products such as cameras

and personal care appliances, signalling expanding use cases for rapid delivery.

Despite the growing presence of quick commerce, analysts believe its impact on marquee sale events remains limited for now.

“Quick commerce is more on categories which are day-to-day needs,” Meena said. “Amazon Now is still expanding. Customers are gradually exploring the pricing and convenience it offers, but it is still work in progress.”

He added that electronics, home appliances, beauty and personal care, and home decor continue to dominate sale events, while FMCG remains a relatively smaller contributor during such promotions.

The performance of these mid-year sales is being closely watched by brands and online retailers as an early indicator of consumer sentiment ahead of the crucial festive shopping season, which typically accounts for the largest share of annual e-commerce sales.

Ministry tightens norms for high alcohol-containing drugs to prevent misuse

Our Bureau
Mumbai



In an effort to prevent the misuse of medicinal products with high alcohol content, the Union Health Ministry has done away with an existing exemption (under Schedule K) from licensing requirements for formulations containing ethyl alcohol.

From now on, these products will also be sold only on a doctor's prescription, the Ministry said.

All formulations containing more than 12 per cent ethyl alcohol, in quantities exceeding 30 ml, would no longer be covered under the exemption provided to them under Schedule K, a note from the Health Ministry said. Consequently, such products will be required to obtain the requisite licences under the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940.

GOVERNANCE NORMS

Homeopathy medicines already have a governance structure in place, a Ministry representative said.

“Certain medicinal products, including tinctures of cardamom, ginger and other aromatic preparations, have been exempted from licensing requirements under Schedule K of the Drugs Rules, 1945. Some of these formulations contain high concentrations of ethyl alcohol, in certain cases up to 80-90 per cent, making them susceptible to misuse for intoxication. References were

also received from certain State governments in this regard,” the Ministry said, explaining the rationale behind the regulation.

The earlier exemption was being misused to sell liquor containing tincture of cardamom and ginger under the guise of medicines, a Ministry source added.

The amendment also shifts these products to Schedule H1 of the Drugs Rules, 1945, which mandates sale against the prescription of a registered medical practitioner and stricter record-keeping, the note added.

“The amendment is expected to strengthen regulatory oversight over those medicinal products containing alcohol, ensuring their supply only through the regulated pharmaceutical supply chain. It will significantly reduce the possibility of diversion and misuse while ensuring their continued availability for legitimate therapeutic use,” it said.

A regulatory expert explained, the tightening of norms will impact cough syrups, digestive syrups, tonics and so on, where alcohol is used for better dissolution and stability.

‘Govt examining WhatsApp reply on usernames notice’

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The government on Friday said it has received the reply from WhatsApp to a notice on ‘usernames’ feature and currently it was “examining” the responses sent by the instant messaging platform.

WhatsApp's reply was received on Thursday night as per the deadline given to the platform by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), sources said.

The notice was issued to the Meta-owned company

on July 1, questioning WhatsApp's proposed username feature, as the government flagged concerns that it could materially increase online fraud, phishing, digital arrest scams and impersonation attacks.

MeitY had also directed the platform not to launch the feature until consultations on the issue are completed “to the satisfaction of the government”.

The username feature essentially allows people on the messaging platform to communicate without sharing their phone numbers.

Subsequently, WhatsApp

had sought some more time to submit its response on the proposed ‘username’ feature and had assured the government that it would not roll it out in India until discussions are complete.

While there was no official comments from both MeitY and WhatsApp, the messaging platform said ‘usernames’ are its latest step to make WhatsApp even more private with no directory to browse and no suggestions.

UNKNOWN CONTACTS

The company noted that people and unknown contacts will need to know a



user's exact username to contact them for the first time and to help control who can reach the person on WhatsApp with the username, the platform has built an optional username key that others will need to know to message.

Embraer eyes 500-aircraft opportunity after DGCA clears E-Jet family

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

Brazilian aircraft manufacturer Embraer sees a potential market for 500 aircraft in India over the next decade following the Directorate General of Civil Aviation's (DGCA) type certification of its E-Jet family, which the company believes will support airlines expanding regional connectivity beyond metro routes.

Accordingly, the certification covers multiple aircraft under the E-Jet family, including the E190, E195 and the E195-E2, while the E175 had already received DGCA type certification and is currently operated in India by Star Air.

NEW ENTRANTS

Speaking to *businessline*, Raul Villaron, Senior Vice-President Sales & Marketing and Head of Region Asia Pacific, Commercial Aviation at



FLEET FLEXIBILITY. The certification positions the aircraft manufacturer to cater to future requirements of both existing airlines and potential new entrants

Embraer, said the certification positions the aircraft manufacturer to cater to future requirements of both existing airlines and potential new entrants looking to deploy small narrow-body aircraft.

“We see a potential market of 500 aircraft over the next 10 years that we could bring to India. The E-Jet family certification allows us to cater to future demand from both existing airlines and possible new entrants that

may look at small narrow-bodies to start operations. The E175 is already flying in India, and we are hopeful of securing further E-Jet orders soon,” he said.

Besides, Villaron said India's regional aviation market continues to present significant opportunities as airlines seek to improve connectivity between smaller cities.

LARGER AIRCRAFT

According to him, airlines currently operate predominantly large narrow-body aircraft and turboprops, leaving substantial opportunities on routes that are too small for larger aircraft but beyond the economic operating range of turboprops.

Furthermore, he said connectivity from major hubs to second- and third-tier cities remains limited and is often served by narrow-body aircraft operating only two to three frequencies a week, while turboprops are primar-

ily deployed on shorter sectors. “This certification enables us to support airlines expanding their networks and opening unique routes by tapping into ‘blue ocean’ opportunities that are too small for a large narrowbody or too far for a turboprop,” Villaron said.

MAJOR HUBS

Additionally, he said the E-Jet family, including the E175 and E190-E2, could enable airlines to connect smaller city pairs directly while bypassing major hubs, thereby improving network connectivity and passenger convenience.

As per Embraer, more than 800 city pairs in India currently remain unserved directly despite generating sufficient demand for aircraft with fewer than 150 seats.

The company estimates that around 90 per cent of these unserved markets involve sectors exceeding 500

kilometres, making them less suitable for turboprop operations.

In addition, Villaron said the E195-E2 is well suited for such routes owing to its fuel efficiency and lower operating costs.

CARGO CAPACITY

He said the aircraft offers passengers improved comfort, faster journey times, lower noise levels and additional cargo capacity compared with turboprops.

On fuel economics, Brazilian aircraft manufacturer said its E195-E2 is currently the world's most fuel-efficient small narrow-body aircraft and features a two-by-two seating configuration without middle seats, larger overhead bins and individual passenger service units.

Globally, the E-Jet programme has recorded more than 1,900 aircraft deliveries and is operated by over 80 airlines across more than 50 countries.

5.25 lakh people flag calls from 1600 and 140 series as spam everyday: Truecaller CEO

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Spammers use phone numbers starting with 1600 and 140 to target people in violation of telecom regulator Telecom Regulatory Authority of India's (TRAI) direction, Truecaller CEO Rishit Jhunjunwala said on Friday, and cited data that 5.25 lakh users of the caller identification app label such calls as spam daily.

The remarks came after the TRAI issued a fresh direction, restraining the practice of tagging, filtering or blocking of calls from phone numbers starting with 1600 and 140.

TRAI clarified that promotional calls originating from 140 number series cannot be tagged or filtered by an app and can only be blocked by

The spammers take advantage of the TRAI rule and use these number series to prey on their targets

the do not disturb (DND) registry.

The Truecaller CEO said that spammers take advantage of the TRAI rule and use these number series to prey on their targets.

SURGE IN SPAM

“TRAI has issued a press release, reiterating that 1600 and 140 series calls cannot be marked as spam by anyone. This is exactly what is leading to the surge in spam from those series. The data

proves without a doubt that spammers are abusing this directive. Why not let us mark numbers from these series as spam if 5.25 lakh people are telling us that it is spam, every single day?” Jhunjunwala said in a social media post on Friday.

The regulator said that it has mandated the use of 1600 series numbers for service and transaction calls by banking, financial services and insurance entities regulated by the RBI, SEBI, IRDAI and PFRDA for reaching out to their customers, as well as by government entities for government-to-citizen communication. The key objective of assigning designated series for these important communications is to make such calls trustworthy for the citizens, TRAI said.

On calls starting with the 140 number series, TRAI said

that it is meant for use by registered telemarketers.

“The customers have the right to allow or block promotional calls originating from 140 series numbers from entities of any or all sectors by registering their preference on the Do Not Disturb (DND) registry,” TRAI said.

PROMOTIONAL CALLS

The regulator said that a customer who has blocked any or all sectors from receiving promotional calls on the DND registry will not receive calls from the 140 series originating from entities of the blocked sectors.

The clarification from TRAI implies that customers will not be able to tag calls from numbers starting with 1600 and the 140 number series as spam, fraud, or any other category.

‘Rising AI token costs push enterprises towards smaller language models’

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

With token costs fluctuating rapidly and organisations struggling to quantify returns, companies are introducing token budgets, monitoring AI usage more closely, and increasingly turning to smaller language models (SLMs) for simpler tasks to keep costs under control while improving return on investment, according to an EY executive.

“Every time a new model comes out, the price of the tokens is high. However, within 3-6 months, when a new competitor emerges, the token price collapses. It's difficult to see the real return on investment from AI because of changing token

costs,” Mahesh Makhija, Partner and Technology Consulting Leader, EY India, explained.

Many companies are experiencing sticker shock as AI token bills climb, prompting closer scrutiny of why costs have risen, which models and agents are driving consumption, and whether those deployments are delivering sufficient value.

MEASURING AI

He added that the most important thing is measuring the value of the tokens consumed.

“For instance, in a certain part of EY consulting, suddenly, I see a \$50,000 or \$75,000 per month spend. This is fine if the consultants using it are seeing fantastic output. But can this be meas-



Mahesh Makhija, Partner and Technology Consulting Leader, EY India

whether the tokens they consume are generating sufficient returns.

COST-EFFECTIVE

To combat this uncertainty, larger firms are resorting to token budgets and closely monitoring token prices. They are also moving towards smaller models, which will be more on-prem and easier to control. “You don't need to use frontier models for everything,” he said.

“The conversation naturally becomes that one doesn't need a large model to do simple tasks. Enterprises are becoming smarter at using parts of open source. That is where the industry will trend also. In a way, SLMs can help combat token costs, and so, there may be a mushrooming of SLMs.”

ured? Can I differentiate between people using AI properly and getting productivity versus those using AI and burning tokens?” he said.

Makhija stressed that companies need to develop appropriate measurement frameworks to assess

[illegible]

*: Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour; 52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Qty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12

구분	구분	구분	구분	구분	구분	구분	구분
구분	구분	구분	구분	구분	구분	구분	구분

Suryoday SFB	177.10	184.30	Ugro Cap	94.66	98.01	Wardwiz.Inn [1]	6.75	7.08
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SW-Solar [1]	230.10	236.55	Unimech Aer [5]	1209.80	1187.65	Welcure Dr [1]	0.26	0.25
Swiggy [1]	280.90	273.10	Uniparts Ind	680.75	702.55			
Sudech Tech [1]	0.28	0.27	Urban Comp [1]	127.05	123.10			

Syncom For [1]	14.01	14.18	UTI Asset	985.50	1003.90	WPIL [1]	476.75	466.75
Syrma SGS	1441.70	1451.25	Utkarsh SFB	14.12	14.63			
Tarsons For [2]	288.20	204.55	Valiant Comm	1070.85	1084.10	Yatharth Hcp	821.55	820.05

Tata Capital L	556.85	600.43	Vedanta Aluminium	444.43	443.35	Yatra Online [1]	112.85	114.20
Tata Tech [2]	711.35	718.55	Vedanta Iron A	33.03	34.68			
Tata Mot CV [2]	419.80	422.55	Vedanta Oil An	37.96	38.74	Group T		

Techno Elec [2]	1047.10	1049.60	Veeram Sec [2]	10.02	10.06	Aastha Spintex	117.05	122.90
Tejas Netwkr	542.45	564.30	Venus Pipes	1804.65	1810.55			

TGV Srac	101.70	101.70	Vikas Life [1]	1.41	1.39	Biogrpaper [1]	6.69	6.67
Timex Group [1]	546.55	568.95	Vikram Solar L	193.40	203.30	Cjan Agro In	1614.40	1629.90

Titan Int [1]	0.95	0.95	Vintage Coff.	163.30	161.50	Csm Technologi	100.80	99.70
TMB	767.85	800.65	VishalMega	116.70	118.95	IdeaForge Te	852.25	894.85

Turtlemint Fin	130.35	136.75	Waaree Re.T[2]	987.65	1015.90	WIPAC Tech	8345.507104.10
TVS Supply [1]	141.55	141.75	Wakefit Innova	125.10	129.25	Quality Power	1156.451214.25

NICE Trade for Trade

Company	BrCl	Cl ₂	Company	BrCl	Cl ₂	Company	BrCl	Cl ₂
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AASTHA SPIN	117.04	122.88	Gaudium IVF	119.18	124.27	PRIME FOC [1]	244.47	256.69
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BAAZAR STYLE	305.55	30.30	IDEAFORGE TEC	857.90	900.75	RAJOO ENGIN	49.99	50.29
Bhagyangri [2]	373.95	383.10	Indiabulls	29.57	29.63	RamaSteel [1]	4.55	4.56
BUFF CUP D [1]	524.15	524.20	Karnadbanu [1]	22.55	22.02	RII COM MV [2]	0.88	0.87

COFFEEDR	32.04	31.93	KhadimIndia	103.13	100.49	Stemite Iec	334.33	343.03
DB Realty	111.14	114.27	KOPRAN.	189.36	196.82	Subex	12.60	13.23
DEF DEVELOPM	672.50	698.70	KRN HEAT EXCH	1211.80	1230.90	SUMMIT INDUS	2.33	2.26

Filatex Fash	0.19	0.19	MTAR TECHNOL 6938.50 7101.00	VIPUL [1]	16.24	16.98
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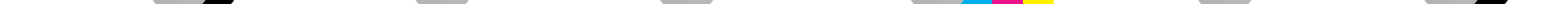










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